

# Linear Algebra by Sterling K. Berberian

Frosty

April 5, 2026

## Contents

|     |                                                                     |    |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| 1   | Vector Spaces                                                       | 1  |
| 1.1 | Motivation (Vectors in 3-space)                                     | 1  |
| 1.2 | $\mathbb{R}^n$ and $\mathbb{C}^n$                                   | 2  |
| 1.3 | Vector Spaces: The Axioms and Examples                              | 3  |
| 1.4 | Vector Spaces: First Consequences of the Axioms                     | 4  |
| 1.5 | Linear Combinations of Vectors                                      | 5  |
| 1.6 | Linear Subspaces                                                    | 7  |
| 2   | Linear Mappings                                                     | 11 |
| 2.1 | Linear Mappings                                                     | 11 |
| 2.2 | Linear Mappings and Linear Subspaces: Kernel and Range              | 13 |
| 2.3 | Spaces of Linear Mappings: $\mathcal{L}(V, W)$ and $\mathcal{L}(V)$ | 14 |
| 2.4 | Isomorphic Vector Spaces                                            | 19 |
| 2.5 | Equivalence Relations and Quotient Sets                             | 22 |
| 2.6 | Quotient Vector Spaces                                              | 24 |
| 2.7 | The First Isomorphism Theorem                                       | 28 |
| 3   | Structure of Vector Spaces                                          | 31 |
| 3.1 | Linear Subspace Generated by a Subset                               | 31 |

## 1 Vector Spaces

### 1.1 Motivation (Vectors in 3-space)

#### Problem 1

Given the point  $P = (2, -1, 3)$  and the vector  $u = [-3, 4, 5]$ , find the point  $Q$  such that  $\overrightarrow{PQ} = u$ .

**Proof.** We require  $\vec{u} = [-3, 4, 5] = (q_1 - 2, q_2 - (-1), q_3 - 3)$ . Solving componentwise, we see  $(q_1, q_2, q_3) = (-1, 3, 8)$ . Thus,  $Q = (-1, 3, 8)$ . ■

#### Problem 2

Given the points  $P(2, -1, 3)$ ,  $Q(3, 4, 1)$ ,  $R(4, -3, 4)$ ,  $S(5, 2, 2)$ . True or false (explain):  $PQSR$  is a parallelogram.

**Proof.** For  $PQSR$  to be a parallelogram, we require  $\vec{PQ} = \vec{SR}$ .

$$\vec{PQ} = [3 - 2, 4 - (-1), 1 - 3] = [1, 5, -2]$$

$$\vec{SR} = [4 - 5, -3 - 2, 4 - 2] = [-1, -5, 2]$$

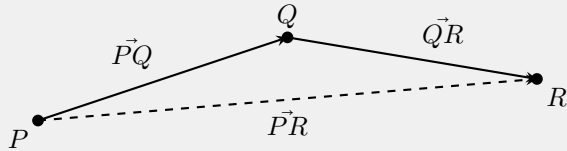
Since

$$[1, 5, -2] \neq [-1, -5, 2],$$

it follows that  $PQSR$  is not a parallelogram. ■

#### Problem 4

Show that for every triple points  $P, Q, R$ ,  $\vec{PQ} + \vec{QR} = \vec{PR}$ . [Method 1: Calculate components. Method 2: Draw a picture.]



## 1.2 $\mathbb{R}^n$ and $\mathbb{C}^n$

#### Problem 2

Consider the vectors  $u = (2, 1)$ ,  $v = (-5, 3)$ ,  $w = (3, 4)$  in  $\mathbb{R}^2$ . Do there exist real numbers  $a, b$  such that  $au + bv = w$ ? What if  $v = (6, 3)$ .

**Proof.** We require  $au + bv = w \iff a(2, 1) + b(-5, 3) = (3, 4) \iff (2a, a) + (-5b, 3b) = (3, 4) \iff (2a - 5b, a + 3b) = (3, 4)$ . Thus

$$\begin{cases} 2a - 5b = 3 \\ a + 3b = 4 \end{cases}$$

which has the solution  $a = \frac{29}{11}$ ,  $b = \frac{5}{11}$ . If  $v = (6, 3)$ , we require

$$a(2, 1) + b(6, 3) = (3, 4) \iff (2a + 6b, a + 3b) = (3, 4).$$

Thus

$$\begin{cases} 2a + 6b = 3 \\ a + 3b = 4 \end{cases}$$

which has no solution. To see this has no solution, note

$$a + 3b = 4 \implies 6b = 8 - 2a.$$

Plugging into the first equation gives

$$2a + (8 - 2a) = 3 \implies 8 = 3,$$

which is a contradiction. ■

#### Problem 3

Give a detailed proof of (8) of Theorem 1.2.3 (just checking!). [Write out all steps of the proof and give a reason for each step.]

**Proof.** Let  $x = [x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n] \in F^n$  be a vector and let  $c, d \in F$  where  $F$  is a field. Then

$$(cd)x = [(cd)x_1, (cd)x_2, \dots, (cd)x_n].$$

Since  $F$  is a field, scalar multiplication in  $F$  is associative thus

$$(cd)x_i = c(dx_i) \quad \text{for each } i = 1, 2, \dots, n.$$

Therefore,

$$(cd)x = [c(dx_1), c(dx_2), \dots, c(dx_n)] = c(dx),$$

#### Problem 4

In Definition 1.2.1,  $n = 1$  is not ruled out. What do the elements of  $\mathbb{R}^1$  look like? Describe sums and scalar multiples in  $\mathbb{R}^1$ .

**Proof.** The elements of  $\mathbb{R}^1$  look like  $[x_1]$  where  $x_1 \in \mathbb{R}$ . Sums and scalar multiples behave identically to the operations in the field  $\mathbb{R}$ .

### 1.3 Vectors Spaces: The Axioms some Examples

#### Problem 1

Let  $V$  be a vector space over a field  $F$ . Let  $T$  be a nonempty set and let  $W = \mathcal{F}(T, V)$  be the set of all functions  $x : T \rightarrow V$ . Show that  $W$  can be made into a vector space over  $F$  in a natural way. [Hint: Use the definitions in Example 1.3.4 as a guide.]

**Proof.** For  $x, y \in W$ ,  $x = y$  means that  $x(t) = y(t)$  for all  $t \in T$ . If  $x, y \in W$  and  $c \in F$ , define functions  $x + y$  and  $cx$  by the formulas  $(x + y)(t) = x(t) + y(t)$  and  $(cx)(t) = cx(t)$  for all  $t \in T$ . Let  $\theta$  be the function defined by  $\theta(t) = 0$  for all  $t \in T$ , and for  $x \in W$ , let  $-x$  be the function defined by  $(-x)(t) = -x(t)$  for all  $t \in T$ .

#### Problem 2

The definition of a vector space (1.3.1) can be formulated as follows. A vector space over  $F$  is a nonempty set  $V$  together with a pair of mappings  $\sigma : V \rightarrow V$  and  $\mu : F \times V \rightarrow V$ . ( $\sigma$  suggests 'sum' and  $\mu$  suggests 'multiple') having the following properties  $\sigma(x, y) = \sigma(y, x)$  for all  $x, y \in V$ ;  $\sigma(\sigma(x, y), z) = \sigma(x, \sigma(y, z))$  for all  $x, y, z \in V$  etc. The exercise: Write out the 'etc.' in detail.

**Proof.** We list the 9 axioms below:

1.  $x, y \in V \implies \sigma(x, y) \in V$
2.  $x \in V, c \in F \implies \mu(c, x) \in V$
3.  $x, y \in V \implies \sigma(x, y) = \sigma(y, x)$
4.  $x, y, z \in V \implies \sigma(x, \sigma(y, z)) = \sigma(\sigma(x, y), z)$
5.  $\exists 0 \in V$  such that  $\sigma(0, v) = v = \sigma(v, 0)$
6.  $x \in V \implies -x \in V$  such that  $\sigma(x, -x) = 0 = \sigma(-x, x)$
7.  $x, y \in V$  and  $c \in F \implies \mu(c, \sigma(x, y)) = \sigma(\mu(c, x), \mu(c, y))$
8.  $\exists 1 \in F$  such that  $x \in V \implies \mu(1, x) = x$
9.  $a, b \in F$  and  $x \in V \implies \mu(a, \mu(b, x)) = \mu(ab, x)$

### Problem 3

Let  $V$  be a complex vector space (1.3.2). Show that  $V$  is also a real vector space (sums as usual, scalar multiplication restricted to real scalars). These two ways of looking at  $V$  may be indicated by writing  $V_c$  and  $V_r$ .

**Proof.** Clearly  $V_r$  is closed under scalar multiplication and vector addition and is a vector space.

### Problem 4

Every real vector space  $V$  can be 'embedded' in a complex vector space  $W$  in the following way: let  $W = V \times V$  be the real vector space constructed as in example 1.3.10 and define multiplication by complex scalars by the formula  $(a + bi)(x, y) = (ax - by, bx + ay)$  for  $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$  and  $(x, y) \in W$ . [In particular,  $i(x, y) = (-y, x)$ . Think of  $(x, y)$  as ' $x + iy$ '] Show that  $W$  satisfies the axioms for a complex vector space ( $W$  is called the complexification of  $V$ ).

**Proof.** Below are the 9 vector space axioms.

1. Let  $x, y \in W$ . Then  $x = (v_1, v_2), y = (w_1, w_2) \in V \times V$ , and  $(v_1, v_2) + (w_1, w_2) = (v_1 + w_1, v_2 + w_2)$ . Now,  $v_1 + w_1 \in V$  and  $v_2 + w_2 \in V$ , thus  $(v_1 + w_1, v_2 + w_2) \in V \times V$ .
2. Let  $x \in W$  and  $c \in \mathbb{C}$ . Then  $x = (v_1, v_2) \in V \times V, c = a + bi \in \mathbb{C}$ , and  $(a + bi)(v_1, v_2) = (av_1 - bv_2, bv_1 + av_2)$ . Clearly  $av_1 - bv_2 \in V$  and  $bv_1 + av_2 \in V$ , thus  $(av_1 - bv_2, bv_1 + av_2) \in V \times V$ .
3. Let  $x, y \in W$ . Then  $x = (v_1, v_2), y = (w_1, w_2) \in V \times V$ . Then  $x + y = (v_1, v_2) + (w_1, w_2) = (v_1 + w_1, v_2 + w_2) = (w_1 + v_1, w_2 + v_2) = (w_1, w_2) + (v_1, v_2) = y + x$ .
4. Let  $x, y, z \in W$ . Then  $x = (v_1, v_2), y = (w_1, w_2), z = (s_1, s_2) \in V \times V$ . Then  $(x + y) + z = [(v_1, v_2) + (w_1, w_2)] + (s_1, s_2) = (v_1 + w_1, v_2 + w_2) + (s_1, s_2) = ((v_1 + w_1) + s_1, (v_2 + w_2) + s_2) = (v_1 + (w_1 + s_1), v_2 + (w_2 + s_2)) = (v_1, v_2) + (w_1 + s_1, w_2 + s_2) = (v_1, v_2) + [(w_1, w_2) + (s_1, s_2)] = x + (y + z)$ .
5. Let  $x \in W$ . Then  $x = (v_1, v_2) \in V \times V$  and  $x + 0 = (v_1, v_2) + (0, 0) = (v_1 + 0, v_2 + 0) = (v_1, v_2)$ .
6. Let  $x \in W$ . Then  $x = (v_1, v_2) \in V \times V$  and  $x + (-x) = (v_1, v_2) + (-v_1, -v_2) = (v_1 - v_1, v_2 - v_2) = (0, 0) = 0 = (-v_1, -v_2) + (v_1, v_2) = (-x) + x$ .
7. Let  $a + bi \in \mathbb{C}$  and  $x, y \in W$ . Then  $(a + bi)((v_1, v_2) + (w_1, w_2)) = (a + bi)(v_1 + w_1, v_2 + w_2) = (a(v_1 + w_1) - b(v_2 + w_2), b(v_1 + w_1) + a(v_2 + w_2)) = (av_1 - bv_2, bv_1 + av_2) + (aw_1 - bw_2, bw_1 + aw_2) = (a + bi)(v_1, v_2) + (a + bi)(w_1, w_2)$ .
8. Let  $a + bi, c + di \in \mathbb{C}$  and  $x = (v_1, v_2) \in W$ . Then  $(a + bi)((c + di)(v_1, v_2)) = (a + bi)(cv_1 - dv_2, dv_1 + cv_2) = ((ac - bd)v_1 - (ad + bc)v_2, (bc + ad)v_1 + (bd + ac)v_2) = ((a + bi)(c + di))(v_1, v_2)$ .
9. Let  $x = (v_1, v_2) \in W$ . Then  $1 \cdot (v_1, v_2) = (1v_1 - 0v_2, 0v_1 + 1v_2) = (v_1, v_2)$ .

## 1.4 Vector Spaces: First Consequences of the Axioms

### Problem 1

In a vector space, ①  $x - y = \theta$  if and only if ②  $x = y$ ; ③  $x + y = z$  if and only if ④  $x = z - y$ .

**Proof.** (①  $\rightarrow$  ②) Suppose  $x - y = \theta \iff x + (-y) = \theta$ . It follows that  $-y = -x \iff y = x$ .

(②  $\rightarrow$  ①) Suppose  $x = y \iff -x = -y$ . Then  $x + (-x) = x + (-y) = x - y = \theta$ .

(③  $\rightarrow$  ④) Suppose  $x + y = z \iff x + y + (-y) = z + (-y) \iff x = z - y$ .

(④  $\rightarrow$  ③) Suppose  $x = z - y \iff x + y = z - y + y \iff x + y = z$ . ■

#### Problem 2

Let  $V$  be a vector space over a field  $F$ . If  $x$  is a fixed nonzero vector, then the mapping  $f : F \rightarrow V$  defined by  $f(c) = cx$  is injective. If  $c$  is a fixed nonzero scalar, then the mapping  $g : V \rightarrow V$  defined by  $g(x) = cx$  is bijective.

**Proof.** Suppose  $x$  is a fixed nonzero vector. Let  $c, c' \in F$  such that  $f(c) = f(c') \iff cx = c'x \iff c = c'$ . The last step follows from Corollary 1.4.7 (ii). Thus  $f$  is injective. ■

**Proof.** Suppose  $c$  is a fixed nonzero scalar. The inverse function to  $g(x) = cx$  is clearly  $g^{-1}(x) = \frac{x}{c}$ . Thus  $g$  is bijective. ■

#### Problem 3

If  $V$  is a vector space and  $y$  is a fixed vector, then the mapping  $\tau : V \rightarrow V$  defined by  $\tau(x) = x + y$  is bijective (it is called translation by the vector  $y$ ).

**Proof.** Suppose  $V$  is a vector space and  $y$  is a fixed vector. The inverse function to  $\tau(x) = x + y$  is clearly  $\tau^{-1}(x) = x - y$ . Thus  $\tau$  is bijective. ■

#### Problem 4

If  $a$  is a nonzero scalar and  $b$  is vector in the space  $V$ , then the equation  $ax + b = \theta$  has a unique solution  $x$  in  $V$ .

**Proof.** Suppose  $a$  is a nonzero scalar and  $b$  is a vector in  $V$ . The equation  $ax + b = \theta$  is equivalent to  $ax = -b$ . Multiplying both sides by  $a^{-1}$  gives  $a^{-1}(ax) = a^{-1}(-b) \iff (a^{-1}a)x = -a^{-1}b \iff x = -a^{-1}b$ . ■

#### Problem 5

If, in a vector space,  $\theta'$  is a vector such that  $\theta' + x = x$  for every vector  $x$ , then  $\theta' = \theta$ . [Hint: Add  $-x$  to both sides of the equation.]

**Proof.** Suppose in a vector space  $\theta'$  is a vector such that  $\theta' + x = x$ . Adding  $-x$  to both sides gives  $\theta' + x + (-x) = x + (-x) \iff \theta' + \theta = \theta \iff \theta' = \theta$ . ■

### 1.5 Linear Combinations of Vectors

#### Problem 1

Express the function  $f(t) = \cos(t - \pi/3)$  as a linear combination of the functions  $\sin t$  and  $\cos t$ .

**Proof.** We use the standard trig identity to find  $f(t) = \cos(t - \pi/3) = \cos(\pi/3)\cos(t) + \sin(\pi/3)\sin(t)$ . ■

### Problem 2

Express the function  $e^t$  as a linear combination of the hyperbolic functions  $\cosh t$  and  $\sinh t$ .

**Proof.** We have the standard identity  $e^t = \cosh(t) + \sinh(t)$ . ■

### Problem 3

Convince yourself of the correctness of the following formulas pertaining to linear combinations in a vector space:

1.  $c \sum_{i=1}^n x_i = \sum_{i=1}^n cx_i$ .
2.  $\sum_{i=1}^n a_i x_i + \sum_{i=1}^n b_i x_i = \sum_{i=1}^n (a_i + b_i)x_i$ .
3.  $\sum_{i=1}^m a_i x_i + \sum_{j=1}^n b_j y_j = \sum_{k=1}^{m+n} c_k z_k$  where  $c_k = a_k$  and  $z_k = x_k$  for  $k = 1, 2, \dots, m$ , while  $c_k = b_{k-m}$  and  $z_k = y_{k-m}$  for  $k = m+1, m+2, \dots, m+n$ .
- 4.

$$\begin{aligned} \left( \sum_{i=1}^m c_i \right) \left( \sum_{j=1}^n x_j \right) &= \sum_{i=1}^m \left( \sum_{j=1}^n c_i x_j \right) \\ &= \sum_{j=1}^n \left( \sum_{i=1}^m c_i x_j \right) \\ &= \sum_{i,j} c_i x_j \end{aligned}$$

The last expression signifying with sum, with  $mn$  terms, of the vectors  $c_i x_j$  for all possible combinations of  $i$  and  $j$ .

**Proof.** I'm convinced. ■

### Problem 5

Show that in a vector space,  $x - y$  is a linear combination of  $x$  and  $y$ .

**Proof.** Let  $\alpha = 1$  and  $\beta = -1$  and it follows that  $x - y = x + (-y) = \alpha x + \beta y$ . ■

### Problem 6

True or false (explain): In  $\mathbb{R}^3$ ,

1. the vector  $x = (0, 6, 3)$  is a linear combination of  $(2, 1, 0)$  and  $(-3, 2, 0)$ ;
2. the vector  $x = (2, 1, -2)$  is a linear combination of  $(2, 1, 0)$  and  $(-3, 2, 0)$ .

**Proof.** We must have

$$(0, 6, 3) = \alpha(2, 1, 0) + \beta(-3, 2, 0) = (2\alpha - 3\beta, \alpha + 2\beta, 0)$$

for  $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{R}$ . We obtain

1.  $0 = 2\alpha - 3\beta$
2.  $6 = \alpha + 2\beta$
3.  $3 = 0$

Since  $3 \neq 0$ , no solution exists. Now suppose

$$(2, 1, -2) = \alpha(2, 1, 0) + \beta(-3, 2, 0) = (2\alpha - 3\beta, \alpha + 2\beta, 0).$$

We obtain

1.  $2 = 2\alpha - 3\beta$
2.  $1 = \alpha + 2\beta$
3.  $-2 = 0$

Since  $-2 \neq 0$ , no solution exists. ■

## 1.6 Linear Subspaces

### Problem 1

Let  $M$  and  $N$  be the subsets of  $\mathbb{R}^2$  defined as follows:

$$M = \{(a, 0) \mid a \in \mathbb{R}\}, N = \{(0, b) \mid b \in \mathbb{R}\}$$

Show that  $M$  and  $N$  are linear subspaces of  $\mathbb{R}^2$  and describe the linear subspaces  $M \cap N$  and  $M + N$ .

**Proof.** First note  $\theta = (0, 0) \in M, N$ . Let  $x, y \in M$  such that  $x = (a_1, 0), y = (a_2, 0)$ . Then  $x + y = (a_1, 0) + (a_2, 0) = (a_1 + a_2, 0) \in M$ . Let  $c \in \mathbb{R}$ . Then  $cx = c(a_1, 0) = (ca_1, 0) \in M$ . The argument for  $N$  is the same. The linear subspace  $M + N$  is all of  $\mathbb{R}^2$ , and the linear subspace  $M \cap N$  is  $\{(0, 0)\}$ . ■

### Problem 2

Let  $\mathcal{F} = \mathcal{R}$  as in Example 1.6.5, fix a nonempty subset  $T$  of  $\mathbb{R}$ , and let

$$M = \{x \in \mathcal{F} \mid x(t) = 0 \text{ for all } t \in T\}$$

Show that  $M$  is a linear subspace of  $\mathcal{F}$ .

**Proof.** Let  $x, y \in M$ . Then for all  $t \in T$ ,  $(x + y)(t) = x(t) + y(t) = 0 + 0 = 0$ , so  $x + y \in M$ . Let  $x \in M$  and  $c \in \mathbb{R}$ . Then for all  $t \in T$ ,  $(cx)(t) = c \cdot x(t) = c \cdot 0 = 0$ , so  $cx \in M$ . Thus  $M$  is a linear subspace of  $\mathcal{F}$ . ■

### Problem 3

With  $\mathcal{F} = \mathcal{F}(\mathbb{R})$  as in 1.6.5, let

$$M = \{x \in \mathcal{F} \mid x = 0 \text{ on } (-\infty, 0]\}$$

$$N = \{x \in \mathcal{F} \mid x = 0 \text{ on } (0, +\infty)\}$$

Prove that  $M + N = \mathcal{F}$  and  $M \cap N = \{\theta\}$ .

**Proof.** Let  $f \in \mathcal{F}$ . Define

$$x(t) = \begin{cases} f(t), & t > 0 \\ 0, & t \leq 0 \end{cases} \in M, \quad y(t) = \begin{cases} f(t), & t \leq 0 \\ 0, & t > 0 \end{cases} \in N.$$

Then  $f = x + y$ , so  $M + N = \mathcal{F}$ . Now, let  $z \in M \cap N$ . Then  $z(t) = 0$  for  $t \leq 0$  and  $z(t) = 0$  for  $t > 0$ . Thus  $z = \theta$  so  $M \cap N = \{\theta\}$ . ■

#### Problem 4

Let  $M$  and  $N$  be linear subspaces of a vector space  $V$ , and let

$$M \cup N = \{x \in V \mid x \in M \text{ or } x \in N\}$$

be the union of  $M$  and  $N$ . True or false (explain):  $M \cup N$  is a linear subspace of  $V$ . [If true, give a proof. If false, give a counterexample (an example of  $V, M, N$  for which  $M \cup N$  is not a linear subspace of  $V$ ).]

**Proof.** Let  $M$  and  $N$  be the subsets of  $\mathbb{R}^2$  defined as follows:

$$M = \{(a, 0) \mid a \in \mathbb{R}\}, \quad N = \{(0, b) \mid b \in \mathbb{R}\}.$$

We showed in Problem 1 that  $M$  and  $N$  are linear subspaces of  $\mathbb{R}^2$ . But notice that  $(1, 0) \in M$  and  $(0, 1) \in N$ , yet  $(1, 0) + (0, 1) = (1, 1) \notin M \cup N$ . ■

#### Problem 6

Let  $V$  be a vector space and let  $A$  be any subset of  $V$ . There exist linear subspaces of  $V$  that contain  $A$  (for instance,  $V$  itself is such a subspace). Let  $n = \{N \mid N \text{ is a linear subspace of } V \text{ containing } A\}$ . Show that  $n$  contains a smallest element. [Try  $\cap n$ .] Thus, there exists a smallest linear subspace of  $V$  containing  $A$ .

**Proof.** Let  $P$  be an arbitrary linear subspace in  $n$ . Clearly, all elements in  $\cap n$  are in  $P$ , thus  $\cap n \subseteq P$ . Now, since all linear subspaces in  $n$  contain 0, we have  $0 \in \cap n$ . Let  $x, y \in \cap n$  and  $c \in F$ , where  $F$  is the field of scalars of  $V$ . Let  $V$  be an arbitrary element in  $n$ . Since  $x, y \in \cap n$ , it follows that  $x, y \in V$ , thus  $x + y \in V$ . Therefore,  $\cap n$  is a linear subspace of  $V$ . ■

#### Problem 7

Let  $V$  be a vector space and let  $n$  be any set of linear subspaces of  $V$ . Let  $A$  be the union of the subspaces in  $n$ , that is,

$$A = \cup n = \{x \in V \mid x \in M \text{ for some } M \in n\}$$

Apply Exercise 6 to conclude that there exists a linear subspace of  $V$  that contains every  $M \in n$ .

**Proof.** Clearly  $\cup n \subseteq V$ . Let  $A = \cup n$ . By Problem 6, there exists a smallest linear subspace of  $V$  containing  $A$ . Since for every  $M \in n$ ,  $M \subseteq A$ , this linear subspace contains every  $M \in n$ . ■

#### Problem 8

A linear subspace  $M$  of a vector of a vector space  $V$  is closed under subtraction: if  $x, y \in M$  then  $x - y \in M$ .

**Proof.** Suppose  $x, y \in M$ , where  $M$  is a linear subspace of a vector space  $V$ . Let  $c = -1$ . Then  $cy = -1 \cdot y = -y \in M$ . Thus  $x + (-y) = x - y \in M$ . ■

#### Problem 9

Let  $V$  be a vector space and let  $n$  be a set of linear subspaces of  $V$ , having the following property: if  $M, N \in n$  then there exists  $P \in n$  such that  $M \subset P$ . (That is, any two elements of  $n$  are contained in a third.) Prove that  $\cup n$  is a linear subspace of  $V$ .



**Proof.** Let  $x, y \in \cup n$  and let  $c$  be a scalar of the vector space  $V$ . Then  $x \in M$  for some  $M \in n$ . Since  $M$  is a linear subspace,  $cx \in M$ , thus  $cx \in \cup n$ . Now  $y \in N$  for some  $N \in n$ . There exists  $P \in n$  such that  $M \subseteq P$  and  $N \subseteq P$ . Thus  $x, y \in P$ . Since  $P$  is a linear subspace,  $x + y \in P$ , thus  $x + y \in \cup n$ . It follows that  $\cup n$  is a linear subspace of  $V$ . ■

#### Problem 11

Let  $M$  and  $N$  be linear subspaces of  $V$ . Prove that the following conditions are equivalent:

1.  $M \cap N = \{\theta\}$ ;
2. if  $y \in M, z \in N$  and  $y + z = \theta$ , then  $y = z = \theta$ ;
3. if  $y + z = y' + z'$ , where  $y, y' \in M$  and  $z, z' \in N$ , then  $y = y'$  and  $z = z'$ .

**Proof.** (1  $\rightarrow$  2) Suppose  $M \cap N = \{\theta\}$ . Furthermore, suppose  $y \in M, z \in N$  and  $y + z = \theta$ . Then  $y = -z \in M$ , so  $z \in M \cap N$ . Since  $M \cap N = \{\theta\}$ , it follows that  $z = \theta$ . Then  $y = -z = -\theta = \theta$ .

(2  $\rightarrow$  3) Suppose that if  $y \in M, z \in N$  and  $y + z = \theta$ , then  $y = z = \theta$ . Suppose  $y + z = y' + z'$ , where  $y, y' \in M$  and  $z, z' \in N$ . Then  $(y - y') + (z - z') = \theta$ . By 2 it follows that  $y - y' = \theta$  and  $z - z' = \theta$ , so  $y = y'$  and  $z = z'$ .

(3  $\rightarrow$  1) Suppose that if  $y + z = y' + z'$ , where  $y, y' \in M$  and  $z, z' \in N$ , then  $y = y'$  and  $z = z'$ . Let  $x \in M \cap N$ . Then  $x \in M$  and  $x \in N$ . Consider  $x + \theta = \theta + x$ . By 3 it follows that  $x = \theta$  and  $\theta = x$ . Therefore  $M \cap N = \{\theta\}$ . ■

#### Problem 12

Let  $M$  and  $N$  be linear subspaces of  $V$ . If  $M + N = V$  and  $M \cap N = \{\theta\}$  (cf. Exercise 11),  $V$  is said to be the direct sum of  $M$  and  $N$ , written  $V = M \oplus N$ . Prove that the following conditions are equivalent:

1.  $V = M \oplus N$ ;
2. for each  $x \in V$ , there exist unique elements  $y \in M$  and  $z \in N$  such that  $x = y + z$ .

**Proof.** ( $\rightarrow$ ) Suppose  $V = M \oplus N$ . Let  $x$  be an arbitrary element in  $V$ . Then there exists  $m \in M$  and  $n \in N$  such that  $x = m + n$ . Suppose there also exists  $m' \in M$  and  $n' \in N$  such that  $x = m' + n'$ . Then  $m + n = m' + n'$ . By Problem 11,  $m = m'$  and  $n = n'$ , thus  $m$  and  $n$  are unique.

( $\leftarrow$ ) Suppose for each  $x \in V$ , there exist unique elements  $y \in M$  and  $z \in N$  such that  $x = y + z$ . Let  $x$  be an arbitrary element in  $V$ . Clearly  $x = y + z$  where  $y \in M$  and  $z \in N$ , thus  $x \in M + N$ . Let  $x$  be an arbitrary element in  $M + N$ . Thus  $x = m + n$  for some  $m \in M$  and  $n \in N$ . Therefore  $V = M + N$ .

Let  $x \in M \cap N$ . Then

$$x = x + \theta \quad \text{with } x \in M, \theta \in N,$$

and

$$x = \theta + x \quad \text{with } \theta \in M, x \in N.$$

Thus  $x = \theta$ . Therefore  $M \cap N = \{\theta\}$ . ■

#### Problem 13

Let  $V$  be the real vector space of all functions  $x : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  (1.3.4). Call  $y \in V$  even if  $y(-t) = y(t)$  for all  $t \in \mathbb{R}$ , and call  $z \in V$  odd if  $z(-t) = -z(t)$  for all  $t \in \mathbb{R}$ . Let

$$M = \{y \in V \mid y \text{ is even}\}, \quad N = \{z \in V \mid z \text{ is odd}\}.$$

1. Prove that  $M$  and  $N$  are linear subspaces of  $V$  and that  $V = M \oplus N$  in the sense of Exercise 12. [Hint: If  $x \in V$  consider the functions of  $y$  and  $z$  defined by  $y(t) = \frac{1}{2}[x(t) + x(-t)]$ ,  $z(t) = \frac{1}{2}[x(t) - x(-t)]$ .]
2. What does (i) say for  $x(t) = e^t$ ?
3. What does (i) say for a polynomial function  $x$ ?

**Proof.** Clearly the zero function is in both  $M$  and  $N$ . Let  $x, y \in M$  and let  $c \in \mathbb{R}$ . Then  $x(-t) = x(t)$  and it follows that  $cx(-t) = cx(t)$ , thus  $cx \in M$ . Also,

$$(x + y)(-t) = x(-t) + y(-t) = x(t) + y(t) = (x + y)(t),$$

thus  $x + y \in M$ . Let  $a, b \in N$  and let  $c \in \mathbb{R}$ . Then  $a(-t) = -a(t)$  and it follows that  $ca(-t) = -ca(t)$ , thus  $ca \in N$ . Also,

$$(a + b)(-t) = a(-t) + b(-t) = -a(t) - b(t) = -(a + b)(t),$$

thus  $a + b \in N$ . It follows that  $M$  and  $N$  are linear subspaces of  $V$ . ■

**Proof.** Let  $x \in V$  be arbitrary. Define functions  $y$  and  $z$  by

$$y(t) = \frac{1}{2}[x(t) + x(-t)], \quad z(t) = \frac{1}{2}[x(t) - x(-t)].$$

Notice

$$y(-t) = \frac{1}{2}[x(-t) + x(t)] = y(t),$$

so  $y$  is even and thus  $y \in M$ . Also

$$z(-t) = \frac{1}{2}[x(-t) - x(t)] = -\frac{1}{2}[x(t) - x(-t)] = -z(t),$$

so  $z$  is odd and thus  $z \in N$ . Now, for all  $t \in \mathbb{R}$ ,

$$y(t) + z(t) = \frac{1}{2}[x(t) + x(-t)] + \frac{1}{2}[x(t) - x(-t)] = x(t).$$

Thus  $x = y + z$  and therefore  $V = M + N$ . Suppose  $x \in M \cap N$ . Then  $x$  is both even and odd and

$$x(t) = x(-t) \quad \text{and} \quad x(t) = -x(-t).$$

Thus  $x(t) = -x(t)$  for all  $t$ ,  $x(t) = 0$  for all  $t$ . Thus  $M \cap N = \{\theta\}$ . Therefore  $V = M \oplus N$ . ■

**Solution (2):** It says that  $e^t$  can be written uniquely as the sum of an even function and an odd function.

**Solution (3):** It says that any polynomial function can be written uniquely as the sum of an even polynomial and an odd polynomial.

#### Problem 16

Let  $V$  and  $W$  be vector spaces over the same field  $F$  and let  $V \times W$  be the product vector space (1.3.11). If  $M$  is a linear subspace of  $V$ , and  $N$  is a linear subspace of  $W$ , show that  $M \times N$  is a linear subspace of  $V \times W$ .

**Proof.** Suppose  $M$  is a linear subspace of  $V$  and  $N$  is a linear subspace of  $W$ . Let  $x, y \in M \times N$  and let  $c$  be a scalar from the field  $F$ . Then  $x = (m_1, n_1)$  and  $y = (m_2, n_2)$  are elements of  $M \times N$ , and  $cx = c(m_1, n_1) = (cm_1, cn_1)$ . Now,  $cm_1 \in M$  and  $cn_1 \in N$ , thus  $cx \in M \times N$ . Also  $x + y = (m_1, n_1) + (m_2, n_2) = (m_1 + m_2, n_1 + n_2)$ . Since  $m_1 + m_2 \in M$  and  $n_1 + n_2 \in N$ , it follows that  $x + y \in M \times N$ . Since  $(\theta_V, \theta_W) \in M \times N$ , it follows that  $M \times N$  is a linear subspace of  $V \times W$ . ■

#### Problem 17

If  $V = V_1 \times V_2$  (1.3.11),  $M_1 = \{(x_1, \theta) \mid x_1 \in V_1\}$  and  $M_2 = \{(\theta, x_2) \mid x_2 \in V_2\}$ , then  $V = M_1 + M_2$  and  $M_1 \cap M_2 = \{\theta\}$  (where  $\theta$  stands for the zero vector of all vector spaces in sight). In the terminology of Exercise 12,  $V$  is the direct sum of its subspaces in  $M_1$  and  $M_2$ , that is,  $V = M_1 \oplus M_2$ . (Generalization?)

**Definition 1.** If  $V = V_1 \times V_2 \times \cdots \times V_n$ , and

1.  $M_1 = \{(x_1, \theta_2, \dots, \theta_n) \mid x_1 \in V_1\}$
2.  $M_2 = \{(\theta_1, x_2, \dots, \theta_n) \mid x_2 \in V_2\}$
3. ...
4.  $M_n = \{(\theta_1, \theta_2, \dots, x_n) \mid x_n \in V_n\}$

then  $V$  is the direct sum of its subspaces  $M_1, M_2, \dots, M_n$ , or

$$V = M_1 \oplus M_2 \oplus \dots \oplus M_n.$$

#### Problem 18

Let  $M$  and  $N$  be linear subspaces of  $V$  whose union  $M \cup N$  is also a linear subspace. Prove that either  $M \subset N$  or  $N \subset M$ . [Hint: Assume to the contrary that neither of  $M, N$  is contained in the other; choose vectors  $y \in M, z \in N$  with  $y \notin N, z \notin M$  and try to find a home for  $y + z$ .]

**Proof.** Let  $y \in M$  and  $z \in N$  such that  $y \notin N$  and  $z \notin M$ . Then  $y \in M \cup N$  and  $z \in M \cup N$ . Since  $M \cup N$  is a linear subspace,  $y + z \in M \cup N$ . Without loss of generality, suppose  $y + z \in M$ . Then  $-y \in M$  by Problem 8. Since  $M$  is closed under addition  $y + z + (-y) = z \in M$  which is a contradiction. ■

## 2 Linear Mappings

### 2.1 Linear Mappings

#### Problem 2

Let  $T$  be a set,  $V = \mathcal{F}(T, \mathbb{R})$  the vector space of all functions  $x : T \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  (Example 1.3.4). Fix a point  $t \in T$  and define  $f : V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  by the formula  $f(x) = x(t)$ . Then  $f$  is a linear form on  $V$ .

**Proof.** Let  $x, y \in V$  and  $c \in \mathbb{R}$ . Then  $f(x + y) = (x + y)(t) = x(t) + y(t) = f(x) + f(y)$ . and  $f(cx) = (cx)(t) = cx(t) = cf(x)$ . Thus  $f$  is a linear mapping. Since it maps functions in  $V$  to scalars in  $\mathbb{R}$  it is a linear form. ■

#### Problem 3

If  $T : V \rightarrow W$  is a linear mapping, then  $T(x - y) = Tx - Ty$  for all  $x, y \in V$ .

**Proof.** Suppose  $T : V \rightarrow W$  is a linear mapping. Let  $x, y$  be arbitrary elements in  $V$ . Then  $T(x - y) = T(x + (-y)) = Tx + T(-y) = Tx + (-T(y)) = Tx - Ty$ . ■

#### Problem 4

If  $V$  is a vector space, prove that the mapping  $T : V \times V \rightarrow V$  defined by  $T(x, y) = x - y$  is linear. (It is understood that  $V \times V$  has the product vector space structure described in Example 1.3.10.)

**Proof.** Suppose  $V$  is a vector space. Let  $(x, y), (a, b)$  be arbitrary elements in  $V \times V$ . Let  $c \in \mathbb{R}$  be a scalar. Then  $T((x, y) + (a, b)) = T(x + a, y + b) = (x + a) - (y + b) = (x - y) + (a - b) = T(x, y) + T(a, b)$ . Also  $T(c(x, y)) = T(cx, cy) = cx - cy = c(x - y) = cT(x, y)$ . Thus  $T$  is linear. ■

**Problem 5**

With notations as in Theorem 2.1.3, an element  $(a_1, \dots, a_n)$  of  $F^n$  such that  $T(a_1, \dots, a_n) = \theta$  is called a (linear) relation among the vectors  $x_1, \dots, x_n$ . For example, suppose that  $V = F^2$ ,  $n = 3$  and  $x_1 = (2, -3)$ ,  $x_2 = (4, 1)$ ,  $x_3 = (8, 9)$ .

1. Find a formula for the linear mapping  $F^3 \rightarrow F^2$  defined in Theorem 2.1.3.
2. Show that  $(-2, 3, 1)$  is a relation among  $x_1, x_2, x_3$ .

**Solution (a):**

$$f(a_1, a_2, a_3) = a_1x_1 + a_2x_2 + a_3x_3$$

**Solution (b):**

$$f(-2, 3, 1) = -2x_1 + 3x_2 - x_3 = -2(2, -3) + 3(4, 1) - (8, 9) = (-4, 6) + (12, 3) - (8, 9) = (8, 9) - (8, 9) = (0, 0) = \theta$$

**Problem 6**

The proof of Theorem 2.1.2 uses only the additivity of the mapping  $T$ . Give a proof using only its homogeneity. [Hint: Corollaries 1.4.3, 1.4.5]

**Theorem 1.** If  $T : V \rightarrow W$  is a linear mapping, then  $T\theta = \theta$  and  $T(-x) = -(Tx)$  for all  $x \in V$ .

**Proof.** Suppose  $T : V \rightarrow W$  is a linear mapping. Then  $T(\theta) = T(0 \cdot x) = 0 \cdot T(x)$ . Then by Corollary 1.4.3,  $0 \cdot T(x) = \theta$ , hence  $T(\theta) = \theta$ . Also  $T(-x) = T((-1) \cdot x) = (-1)T(x)$ . Then by Corollary 1.4.5,  $(-1)T(x) = -T(x)$ . Thus  $T(-x) = -Tx$ . ■

**Problem 7**

If  $\mathcal{D}$  is the vector space of real polynomial functions (Example 1.3.5) and  $f : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is the mapping defined by  $f(p) = p'(1)$  (the value of the derivative of  $p$  at 1), then  $f$  is a linear form on  $\mathcal{D}$ . What is the geometric meaning of  $f(p) = 0$ ?

**Proof.** Let  $x, y \in \mathcal{D}$  and  $c \in \mathbb{R}$ . Then  $f(x+y) = (x+y)'(1) = x'(1) + y'(1) = f(x) + f(y)$ . and  $f(cx) = (cx)'(1) = c x'(1) = c f(x)$ . It follows that  $f$  is a linear form on  $\mathcal{D}$ . ■

**Solution:**  $f(p) = 0$  is a critical point at the value  $x = 1$  of the function  $p$ .

**Problem 8**

Let  $S : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$  be the linear mapping of Example 2.1.5. Define  $R : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$  by  $Rp = Sp + p(5)1$ , where  $p(5)1$  is the constant function defined by the real number  $p(5)$ . Then  $R$  is linear and  $(Rp)' = p$ . [So to speak, the constant of integration can be tailor-made for  $p$  in a linear fashion.] More generally, look at the mapping  $Rp = Sp + f(p)1$ , where  $f$  is any linear form on  $\mathcal{D}$ .

**Proof.** Let  $x, y \in \mathcal{D}$  and  $c \in \mathbb{R}$ . Then  $R(x+y) = S(x+y) + (x+y)(5)1 = S(x) + S(y) + x(5)1 + y(5)1 = R(x) + R(y)$ . Also  $R(cx) = S(cx) + (cx)(5)1 = cS(x) + cx(5)1 = cR(x)$ . Thus  $R$  is linear.

For the general form notice  $R(x+y) = S(x+y) + f(x+y)1 = S(x) + S(y) + f(x)1 + f(y)1 = R(x) + R(y)$ . Also  $R(cx) = S(cx) + f(cx)1 = cS(x) + cf(x)1 = cR(x)$ . ■

## 2.2 Linear Mappings and Linear Subspaces: Kernel and Range

### Problem 2

Let  $V$  be a vector space over  $F$ ,  $f : V \rightarrow F$  a linear form on  $V$  (Definition 2.1.11). Assume that  $f$  is not identically zero and choose a vector  $y$  such that  $f(y) \neq 0$ . Let  $N$  be the kernel of  $f$ . Prove that every vector  $x$  in  $V$  may be written  $x = z + cy$  with  $z \in N$  and  $c \in F$ , and that  $z$  and  $c$  are uniquely determined by  $x$ . [Hint: If  $x \in V$ , compute the value of  $f$  at the vector  $x - [f(x)/f(y)]y$ .]

**Proof.** Suppose  $x, y \in V$ . Notice  $f\left(x - \frac{f(x)}{f(y)}y\right) = f(x) - f\left(\frac{f(x)}{f(y)}y\right) = f(x) - \frac{f(x)}{f(y)}f(y) = f(x) - f(x) = 0$ . We've just shown  $x - \frac{f(x)}{f(y)}y \in \ker(f)$ . Thus  $x = \left(x - \frac{f(x)}{f(y)}y\right) + \frac{f(x)}{f(y)}y$ . Let  $z = x - \frac{f(x)}{f(y)}y$  and  $c = \frac{f(x)}{f(y)}$ , and we see  $x = z + cy$  as required.

Suppose  $x = z' + c'y$  with  $z' \in \ker(f)$  and  $c' \in F$ . Then  $z + cy = z' + c'y \implies z - z' = (c' - c)y$ . Applying  $f$  gives  $0 = f(z - z') = (c' - c)f(y)$ , so  $c' - c = 0$  since  $f(y) \neq 0$ . Thus  $c' = c$  and  $z' = z$ . ■

### Problem 3

Let  $S : V \rightarrow W$  and  $T : V \rightarrow W$  be linear mappings and let  $M = \{x \in V \mid Sx \in T(V)\}$ . Prove that  $M$  is a linear subspace of  $V$ .

**Proof.** Let  $x, y \in M$  and let  $c$  be a scalar of the vector space  $V$ . Since  $x, y \in M$ , we have  $Sx \in T(V)$  and  $Sy \in T(V)$ . Since  $T(V)$  is a linear subspace of  $W$  it follows that  $S(x + y) = Sx + Sy \in T(V)$ . Thus  $x + y \in M$ . Similarly  $S(cx) = cS(x) \in T(V)$  thus  $cx \in M$ . Therefore  $M$  is a linear subspace of  $V$ . ■

### Problem 4

If  $T : V \times V \rightarrow V$  is the linear mapping  $T(x, y) = x - y$  (2.1, Exercise 4), determine the kernel and range of  $T$ .

**Solution:** The kernel is  $(x, x) \in V \times V$  and the range is  $V$ .

### Problem 5

Let  $V$  be a real vector space,  $W$  its complexification (1.3, Exercise 4); write  $W_R$  for  $W$  regarded as a real vector space (1.3, Exercise 3). For  $(x, y) \in W$ , we have

$$(x, y) = (x, \theta) + (\theta, y) = (x, \theta) + i(y, \theta).$$

Prove that  $x \mapsto (x, \theta)$  is an injective mapping  $V \rightarrow W_R$ . [Identifying  $x \in V$  with  $(x, \theta) \in W$ , one can suggestively write  $W = V + iV$ ; so to speak,  $V$  is the 'real part' of its complexification.]

**Proof.**

$$x(x_1) = x(x_2) \iff (x_1, 0) = (x_2, 0) \iff x_1 = x_2$$

### Problem 6

Let  $\mathcal{D}$  be the vector space of real polynomial functions (1.3.5) and let  $T : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$  be the linear mapping defined by  $Tp = p - p'$ , where  $p'$  is the derivative of  $p$ . Prove that  $T$  is injective.

**Proof.** Suppose  $x, y \in \mathcal{D}$  such that  $T(x) = T(y)$ . Then  $T(x) = T(y) \iff x - x' = y - y' \iff (x - y) - (x' - y') = 0$ . Let  $q = x - y$  then  $q - q' = 0 \iff q = q'$ . Thus  $q = 0$  and it follows that  $x = y$  and  $x' = y'$ . ■

## 2.3 Spaces of Linear Mappings: $\mathcal{L}(V, W)$ and $\mathcal{L}(V)$

### Problem 1

Complete the details in the proof of Theorem 2.3.11.

**Theorem 2.** If  $V$  and  $W$  are vector spaces over  $F$ , then  $\mathcal{L}(V, W)$  is also a vector space over  $F$  for the operations defined in 2.3.9.

**Proof.** Let  $S, T \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$  and let  $a, b \in F$ . For all  $x \in V$ ,  $(a(S + T))(x) = a((S + T)(x)) = a(S(x) + T(x)) = aS(x) + aT(x) = (aS + aT)(x)$ . For all  $x \in V$ ,  $((a + b)T)(x) = (a + b)T(x) = aT(x) + bT(x) = (aT + bT)(x)$ . For all  $x \in V$ ,  $((ab)T)(x) = abT(x) = a(bT(x)) = (a(bT))(x)$ . For all  $x \in V$ ,  $(1T)(x) = 1 \cdot T(x) = T(x)$ . ■

### Problem 2

Let  $V$  be a vector space. If  $R, S, T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$  and  $c$  is a scalar, the following equalities are true.

1.  $(RS)T = R(ST)$ ;
2.  $(R + S)T = RT + ST$ ;
3.  $R(S + T) = RS + RT$ ;
4.  $(cS)T = c(ST) = S(cT)$ ;
5.  $TI = T = IT$ ; ( $T$  is the identity mapping)

**Proof.** For all  $x \in V$ .

1.  $(RS)T(x) = R(S(T(x))) = R(ST(x)) = (R(ST))(x)$ .
2.  $(R + S)T(x) = (R + S)(T(x)) = R(T(x)) + S(T(x)) = RT(x) + ST(x) = (RT + ST)(x)$ .
3.  $R(S + T)(x) = R(S(x) + T(x)) = R(S(x)) + R(T(x)) = RS(x) + RT(x) = (RS + RT)(x)$ .
4.  $(cS)T(x) = cS(T(x)) = c(ST(x)) = (c(ST))(x) = S(cT)(x)$ .
5.  $TI(x) = T(I(x)) = T(x)$  and  $IT(x) = I(T(x)) = T(x)$ .

### Problem 4

If  $T : V \rightarrow W$  is a linear mapping and  $g$  is a linear form on  $W$ , show that the formula  $f(x) = g(Tx)$  defines a linear form  $f$  on  $V$ . [Shortcut:  $f = gT = g \circ T$ ] The formula  $T'g = f$  defines a mapping  $T' : \mathcal{L}(W, F) \rightarrow \mathcal{L}(V, F)$ , where  $F$  is the field of scalars. Show that  $T'$  is linear. [ $T'$  is called the transpose (or 'adjoint' of  $T$ ).]

**Proof.** By Theorem 2.3.13 it directly follows that  $f$  is linear.

Let  $x, y \in \mathcal{L}(W, F)$  and  $c$  be a scalar in  $F$ . Then for all  $v \in V$ ,  $T'(x + y)(v) = (x + y)(T(v)) = x(T(v)) + y(T(v)) = T'(x)(v) + T'(y)(v)$ . Similarly,  $T'(cx)(v) = (cx)(T(v)) = c x(T(v)) = c T'(x)(v)$ . Therefore,  $T'$  is linear. ■

### Problem 5

If  $V$  is a vector space over  $F$ , the vector space  $\mathcal{L}(V, F)$  of linear forms on  $V$  is called the dual space of  $V$  and is denoted  $V'$ . Thus, the correspondence  $T \mapsto T'$  described in Exercise 4 defines a mapping  $\mathcal{L}(V, W) \rightarrow \mathcal{L}(W', V')$ . Show that this mapping is linear, that is,  $(S + T)' = S' + T'$  and  $(cT)' = cT'$  for all  $S, T$  in

$\mathcal{L}(V, W)$  and all scalars  $c$ .

**Proof.** Let  $S, T \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$  and let  $c$  be a scalar. Let  $v$  be a vector in  $V$ . Then  $(S + T)'g(v) = g(S + T)(v) = g(S(v) + T(v)) = gS(v) + gT(v) = S'g(v) + T'g(v)$ . Similarly  $(cT)'g(v) = g(cT(v)) = cgT(v) = c(T'g)(v)$ . Thus the correspondence  $T \mapsto T'$  is linear. ■

#### Problem 6

With notations as in Exercise 4, prove that if  $T$  is surjective then  $T'$  is injective; in other words, show that if  $T(V) = W$  then  $T'g = 0 \implies g = 0$ .

**Proof.** Suppose  $T(V) = W$  and  $T'g = 0$ . Let  $v \in V$  then  $(T'g)(v) = g(T(v)) = 0$  for all  $v \in V$ . Thus  $g = 0$  and  $T'$  is injective. ■

#### Problem 7

As in Example 2.1.4, let  $V = \mathcal{D}$  be the real vector space of all polynomial functions  $p : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ ,  $D : V \rightarrow V$  the linear mapping defined by  $Dp = p'$  (the derivative of  $p$ ); let  $D' : V' \rightarrow V'$  be the transpose of  $D$  as defined in Exercise 4. (Caution: The prime is being used with three different meanings.)

For each  $t \in \mathbb{R}$  let  $\rho_t$  be the linear form on  $V$  defined by  $\rho_t(p) = p(t)$ . Let  $[a, b]$  be a closed interval on  $\mathbb{R}$  and let  $\rho$  be the linear form on  $V$  defined by

$$\rho(p) = \int_a^b p(t)dt$$

Prove :  $D'\rho = \rho_b - \rho_a$ . [Hint: Fundamental Theorem of Calculus.]

**Proof.** Let  $p \in V$ . Notice  $(D'\rho)(p) = \rho(Dp) = \int_a^b p'(t)dt = p(b) - p(a) = \rho_b(p) - \rho_a(p)$ . ■

#### Problem 9

Let  $U, V, W$  be vector spaces over  $F$ . Prove:

1. For fixed  $T \in \mathcal{L}(U, V)$ ,  $\psi = S \mapsto ST$  is a linear mapping  $\mathcal{L}(V, W) \rightarrow \mathcal{L}(U, W)$  (see Figure 8 2.3.12).
2. For fixed  $S \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$ ,  $\phi = T \mapsto ST$  is a mapping  $\mathcal{L}(U, V) \rightarrow \mathcal{L}(U, W)$ .

**Proof.** Let  $x, y \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$  and  $v \in U$ . Let  $c$  be a scalar. Then  $(\psi(x + y))(v) = ((x + y)T)(v) = (x + y)(T(v)) = xT(v) + yT(v) = \psi(x)(v) + \psi(y)(v)$ . Also  $(\psi(cx))(v) = ((cx)T)(v) = (cx)(T(v)) = c(xT(v)) = c\psi(x)(v)$ . Thus  $\psi$  is a linear mapping. ■

**Proof.** Let  $x, y \in \mathcal{L}(U, V)$  and  $v \in U$ . Let  $c$  be a scalar. Then  $(\phi(x + y))(v) = S(x + y)(v) = S(x(v) + y(v)) = S(x(v)) + S(y(v)) = \phi(x)(v) + \phi(y)(v)$ . Also  $(\phi(cx))(v) = S(cx(v)) = cS(x(v)) = c\phi(x)(v)$ . Thus  $\phi$  is a linear mapping. ■

#### Problem 10

If  $T : U \rightarrow V$  and  $S : V \rightarrow W$  are linear mappings, prove that  $Im(ST) \subset ImS$  and  $Ker(ST) \supset KerT$ .

**Proof.** Clearly  $T$  can only restrict the domain of  $S$  thus  $Im(ST) \subset ImS$ . Clearly any  $x$  in  $KerT$  will be in  $Ker(ST)$  since  $S(0) = 0$ . ■

**Problem 11**

Let  $T : V \rightarrow V$  be a linear mapping such that  $\text{Im}T \subset \text{Ker}(T - I)$ , where  $I$  is the identity mapping (2.3.3). Prove that  $T^2 = T$ . [Recall  $T^2 = TT$ .]

**Proof.** First note that  $\text{Ker}(T - I) = \{v \in V \mid (T - I)(v) = 0\}$ . For any  $v \in V$ ,  $(T - I)(v) = 0 \iff T(v) - I(v) = 0 \iff T(v) - v = 0 \iff T(v) = v$ . Let  $v \in V$  be arbitrary. Then  $T(v) \in \text{Im}T$ . Since  $\text{Im}T \subset \text{Ker}(T - I)$ , it follows that  $T(v) \in \text{Ker}(T - I)$ , and thus  $T(T(v)) = T(v)$ . Thus  $T^2 = T$ . ■

**Problem 12**

Suppose  $V = M \oplus N$  in the sense of 1.6, Exercise 12. For each  $x \in V$ , let  $x = y + z$  be its unique decomposition with  $y \in M, z \in N$  and define  $Px = y, Qx = z$ . Prove that  $P, Q \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ ,  $P^2 = P, Q^2 = Q, P + Q = I$  and  $PQ = QP = 0$ .

**Proof.** Let  $a_1, a_2 \in M$  and  $b_1, b_2 \in N$ . Let  $x = a_1 + b_1, y = a_2 + b_2 \in V$ . Then  $P(x + y) = P((a_1 + a_2) + (b_1 + b_2)) = a_1 + a_2 = Px + Py$ . Also  $P(cx) = P(c(a_1 + b_1)) = P(ca_1 + cb_1) = ca_1 = c(Px)$ . Thus  $P \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ . The argument that  $Q \in \mathcal{L}(V)$  is similar. ■

**Proof.** Simply note that  $\text{Im}P \subset \text{Ker}(P - I)$  thus  $P^2 = P$ . The argument that  $Q^2 = Q$  is similar. ■

**Proof.** Let  $a \in M$  and  $b \in N$ . Let  $x = a + b$ . Then  $(P + Q)(x) = P(x) + Q(x) = a + b = x$ . Thus  $P + Q = I$ . ■

**Proof.** Let  $a \in M$  and  $b \in N$ . Let  $x = a + b$ . Then  $(PQ)(x) = P(Q(x)) = P(Q(a + b)) = P(0 + Q(b)) = 0$ . The argument for  $QP$  is similar. ■

**Problem 13**

Let  $T : V \rightarrow V$  be a linear mapping such that  $T^2 = T$ , and let  $M = \text{Im}T$  and  $N = \text{Ker}T$ . Prove that  $M = \{x \in V \mid Tx = x\} = \text{Ker}(T - I)$  and that  $V = M \oplus N$  in the sense of 1.6, Exercise 12.

**Proof.** Notice  $x \in M \iff Tx = x \iff Tx - x = 0 \iff Tx - Ix = 0 \iff (T - I)(x) = 0 \iff x \in \text{Ker}(T - I)$ . Let  $x \in V$ . Let  $y = Tx \in M$  and  $z = x - Tx \in N$ . Notice

$$T(z) = T(x - Tx) = Tx - T^2x = Tx - Tx = 0$$

Thus  $z \in \text{Ker}T = N$ . Therefore  $x = y + z \in M + N$ . Suppose  $x = y_1 + z_1 = y_2 + z_2$  with  $y_i \in M, z_i \in N$ . Then

$$y_1 - y_2 = z_2 - z_1 \in M \cap N.$$

But then  $M \cap N = \{0\}$  because suppose  $v \in M \cap N$ , then  $Tv = v$  and  $Tv = 0$ , so  $v = 0$ . Thus  $V = M \oplus N$ . ■

**Problem 14**

Find  $S, T \in \mathcal{L}(\mathbb{R}^2)$  such that  $ST \neq TS$ .

**Proof.** Consider the linear maps  $S, T \in \mathcal{L}(\mathbb{R}^2)$

$$S(x, y) = (y, 0), \quad T(x, y) = (0, x).$$

Then for any  $(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2$

$$ST(x, y) = S(T(x, y)) = S(0, x) = (x, 0),$$

$$TS(x, y) = T(S(x, y)) = T(y, 0) = (0, y).$$

Thus  $ST \neq TS$ . ■



**Problem 15**

Let  $T : U \rightarrow V$  and  $S : V \rightarrow W$  be linear mappings. Prove

1. If  $S$  is injective, then  $\text{Ker}(ST) = \text{Ker}(T)$ .
2. If  $T$  is surjective, then  $\text{Im}(ST) = \text{Im}S$ .

**Proof.** Suppose  $S$  is injective. Let  $x$  be an arbitrary element in  $U$ . Suppose  $x \in \text{Ker}(T)$  thus  $T(x) = 0$ . Then  $(ST)(x) = S(T(x)) = S(0) = 0$ . Thus  $x \in \text{Ker}(ST)$ . Suppose  $x \in \text{Ker}(ST)$  thus  $(ST)(x) = 0$ . Now  $S(0) = 0$  and since  $S(T(x)) = 0$  and  $S$  is injective,  $T(x) = 0$  thus  $x \in \text{Ker}T$ . It follows that  $\text{Ker}(ST) = \text{Ker}(T)$ . ■

**Proof.** Suppose  $T$  is surjective. It follows that  $T$  maps onto all elements in the domain of  $S$ . Therefore  $\text{Im}(ST) = \text{Im}S$ . ■

**Problem 16**

Let  $V$  be a real or complex vector space and let  $t \in \mathcal{V}$  be such that  $T^2 = I$ . Define

$$M = \{x \in V \mid Tx = x\}, \quad N = \{x \in V \mid Tx = -x\}$$

Prove that  $M$  and  $N$  are linear subspaces of  $V$  such that  $V = M \oplus N$ . [Hint: For every vector  $x$ ,  $x = \frac{1}{2}(x + Tx) + \frac{1}{2}(x - Tx)$ .]

**Proof.** Let  $x \in V$  and consider  $x = \frac{1}{2}(x + Tx) + \frac{1}{2}(x - Tx)$ . Let  $m = \frac{1}{2}(x + Tx)$  and  $n = \frac{1}{2}(x - Tx)$ . Then  $Tm = \frac{1}{2}(Tx + T^2x) = \frac{1}{2}(Tx + x) = m$  so  $m \in M$ , and  $Tn = \frac{1}{2}(Tx - T^2x) = \frac{1}{2}(Tx - x) = -n$  so  $n \in N$ . Thus  $x = m + n \in M + N$ .

Suppose  $v \in M \cap N$ . Then  $Tv = v$  and  $Tv = -v$ , which implies  $v = 0$ . Thus  $M \cap N = \{0\}$ . It follows that  $V = M \oplus N$ . ■

**Problem 17**

Let  $V = \mathcal{F}(\mathbb{R})$  be the real vector space of all functions  $x : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  (1.3.4). For  $x \in V$  define  $Tx \in V$  by the formula  $(Tx)(t) = x(-t)$ . Analyze  $T$  in the light of Exercise 16. [Remember 1.6, Exercise 13]

**Solution:** The set of functions for which  $x(t) = x(-t)$ , i.e., the even functions, are in  $M$ . The functions for which  $x(t) = -x(-t)$ , i.e., the odd functions, are in  $N$ . Every function  $x \in V$  can be expressed as  $x = \frac{1}{2}(x + Tx) + \frac{1}{2}(x - Tx) \in M \oplus N$ .

**Problem 18**

Let  $T \in \mathcal{L}(U, V)$  and  $S \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$ , prove that  $(ST)' = T'S'$ . (cf. Exercise 4).

**Proof.** Let  $f \in W'$  be a linear form on  $W$ . Then  $(ST)'(f) = f \circ (ST) = (f \circ S) \circ T = T'(S'(f))$ . ■

**Problem 19**

Let  $S, T \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$  and let  $M = \{x \in V \mid Sx = Tx\}$ . Prove that  $M$  is a linear subspace of  $V$ . [Hint: Consider  $\text{Ker}(S - T)$ .]

**Proof.** Note that  $M = \{x \in V \mid Sx - Tx = 0\} = \{x \in V \mid (S - T)x = 0\} = \text{ker}(S - T)$ . Since the kernel of a linear map is always a linear subspace,  $M$  is a linear subspace of  $V$ . ■

**Problem 20**

If  $T : V \rightarrow W, S : W \rightarrow V$  are linear mappings such that  $ST = I$ , prove that  $\text{Ker}T = \{0\}$  and  $\text{Im}S = V$ .

**Proof.** Let  $x \in \text{Ker}T$  such that  $Tx = 0$ . Then  $STx = Tx = 0$ . Since  $ST = I$ , we have  $x = 0$  thus  $\text{Ker}T = \{0\}$ .

Next, let  $v \in V$ . Then  $v = Iv = STv = S(Tv)$ . Thus  $v \in \text{Im}S$ . Therefore  $\text{Im}S = V$ . ■

**Problem 21**

If  $V = \{\theta\}$  or  $W = \{\theta\}$  then  $\mathcal{L}(V, W) = \{0\}$ . If  $V \neq \{\theta\}$  then  $I_v \neq 0$ .

**Proof.** Suppose  $V = \{\theta\}$  or  $W = \{\theta\}$ . Clearly there is only one linear mapping between  $V$  and  $W$  which is for all  $x \in V, T(x) = 0 \in W$ .

Suppose  $V \neq \{\theta\}$ .  $V$  has at least two elements, one of which maps to 0. The other must map to a nonzero element under  $I_V$ . ■

**Problem 22**

A lightning proof of Theorem 2.3.11 can be based on an earlier exercise: Since  $0 \in \mathcal{L}(V, W)$ , Lemma 2.3.10 shows that  $\mathcal{V}, \mathcal{W}$  is a linear subspace of the vector space  $\mathcal{F}(V, W)$  defined as in 1.3, Exercise 1, therefore  $\mathcal{L}(V, W)$  is also a vector space (1.6.2).

Solution: OK.

**Problem 23**

If  $T : U \rightarrow V$  and  $S : V \rightarrow W$  are linear mappings, prove that  $\text{Ker}(ST) = T^{-1}(\text{Ker}S)$ .

**Proof.** Let  $x \in U$ . Then

$$x \in \text{Ker}(ST) \iff STx = 0 \iff S(Tx) = 0 \iff Tx \in \text{Ker}S \iff x \in T^{-1}(\text{Ker}S).$$

Therefore  $\text{Ker}(ST) = T^{-1}(\text{Ker}S)$ . ■

**Problem 24**

Let  $V = \mathcal{D}$  be the vector space of real polynomial functions,  $D : V \rightarrow V$  the differentiation mapping  $Dp = p'$  (2.1.4). Let  $u$  be the monomial  $u(t) = t$  and define another linear mapping  $M : V \rightarrow V$  by the formula  $Mp = up$ . (So to speak,  $M$  is multiplication by  $t$ .) Prove that  $DM - MD = I$  (the identity mapping). [Hint: The claim is that  $(up)' - up' = p$ . Remember the 'product rule'!]

**Proof.** By the product rule,

$$(up)' = u'p + up'.$$

Since  $u(t) = t$  we know  $u' = 1$ . Thus

$$(up)' = p + up'.$$

### Problem 25

Let  $D : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$  be the differentiating map of Exercise 24 and let  $S : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$  be the linear mapping such that  $(Sp)' = p$  and  $(Sp)(0) = 0$  (2.1.5). Prove:

1. If  $R : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$  is any linear mapping such that  $(Rp)' = p$  for all  $p \in \mathcal{D}$ , then  $DR = I$ .
2. If  $T : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$  is a linear mapping such that  $DT = 0$ , then there exists a linear form  $f$  on  $\mathcal{D}$  such that (in the notation of Exercise 2.3.4)  $T = f \otimes 1$ , where  $1$  is the constant function  $1$ . [Hint:  $\text{Im} T \subset \text{Ker} D$ .]
3. With  $R$  as in (i),  $R = S + f \otimes 1$  for a suitable linear form  $f$  on  $\mathcal{D}$ . [Hint: Consider  $T = R - S$ .] Remember 2.1, Exercise 8?

**Proof.** Suppose  $R : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$  is a linear mapping such that  $(Rp)' = p$  for all  $p \in \mathcal{D}$ . Let  $p \in \mathcal{D}$ . Then  $(DR)(p) = D(Rp) = (Rp)' = p$ . Thus  $DR = I$ . ■

**Proof.** If  $T : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$  is a linear mapping such that  $DT = 0$ , then for all  $p \in \mathcal{D}$ ,  $Tp$  is a constant function. Thus  $T = T \otimes 1$ , where  $1$  is the constant function  $1$ . ■

**Proof.** Let  $R : \mathcal{D} \rightarrow \mathcal{D}$  and let  $T = R - S$ . Then for any  $p \in \mathcal{D}$ ,  $D(Tp) = D((R - S)p) = DR(p) - DS(p) = I(p) - I(p) = 0$ . Thus  $DT = 0$ . By part (ii), there exists a linear form  $f$  on  $\mathcal{D}$  such that  $T = f \otimes 1$ . Therefore  $R = S + T = S + f \otimes 1$ . ■

### Problem 26

Let  $S, T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ . If  $ST - I$  is injective then so is  $TS - I$ . [Hint:  $S(TS - I) = (ST - I)S$ .]

**Proof.** Suppose  $ST - I$  is injective. Thus  $\ker(ST - I) = \{0\}$ . Suppose  $x \in V$  such that  $(TS - I)(x) = 0$ . Then applying  $S$  we have  $S(TS - I)(x) = 0$ . By the hint we have  $((ST - I)S)(x) = 0 \iff (ST - I)(S(x)) = 0$ . Since  $ST - I$  is injective we have  $S(x) = 0$ . Then  $(TS - I)(x) = TS(x) - x = T0 - x = -x = 0$ . Thus  $x = 0$ . ■

## 2.4 Isomorphic Vector Spaces

### Problem 2

Regard  $\mathbb{C}^n$  as a real vector space in the natural way (sums as usual, multiplication only by real scalars); then  $\mathbb{C}^n \cong \mathbb{R}^{2n}$  as real vector spaces.

**Proof.** Let  $r_1, r_2, \dots, r_{2n-1}, r_{2n} \in \mathbb{R}$ . Consider the mapping

$$(r_1, r_2, \dots, r_{2n-1}, r_{2n}) \mapsto (r_1 + r_2i, \dots, r_{2n-1} + r_{2n}i).$$

We know that the map  $(r_1, r_2) \mapsto r_1 + r_2i$  is linear and bijective over  $\mathbb{R}$ . Our mapping is simply an extension of this map to  $n$  components and is therefore linear and bijective. ■

### Problem 3

Let  $X$  be a set,  $V$  a vector space,  $f : X \rightarrow V$  a bijection. There exists a unique vector space structure on  $X$  for which  $f$  is a linear mapping (hence a vector space isomorphism). [Hint: Define sums and scalar multiples in  $X$  by the formulas  $x + y = f^{-1}(f(x) + f(y))$ ,  $cx = f^{-1}(cf(x))$ . This trick is called 'transport of structure'.]

**Proof.** Clearly  $X$  is a vector space, since after applying  $f$  each vector space axiom becomes the corresponding axiom in  $V$ , and injectivity of  $f$  implies the axioms hold in  $X$ . ■

#### Problem 4

Let  $V$  be the set of  $n$ -ples  $x = (x_1, \dots, x_n)$  of real numbers  $> 0$ , that is,

$$V = \{(x_1, \dots, x_n) \mid x_i \in (0, +\infty) \text{ for } i = 1, \dots, n\}.$$

For  $x = (x_1, \dots, x_n), y = (y_1, \dots, y_n)$  in  $V$  and  $c \in \mathbb{R}$ , define

$$x \oplus y = (x_1 y_1, \dots, x_n y_n), c \cdot x = (x_1^c, \dots, x_n^c),$$

(here  $x_i y_i$  and  $x_i^c$  are the usual product and power), Define a mapping  $T : V \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$  by the formula  $T(x_1, \dots, x_n) = (\log x_1, \dots, \log x_n)$ .

1. Show that  $T(x \oplus y) = Tx + Ty$  and  $T(c \cdot x) = c(Tx)$  for all  $x, y$  in  $V$  and all  $c \in \mathbb{R}$ .
2. True or false (explain):  $V$  is a real vector space for the operations  $\cdot$ .

**Proof.** Let  $x, y \in V$  and  $c$  be a scalar. Then

$$\begin{aligned} T(x \oplus y) &= T((x_1 y_1, \dots, x_n y_n)) = (\log(x_1 y_1), \dots, \log(x_n y_n)) = (\log x_1 + \log y_1, \dots, \log x_n + \log y_n) \\ &= (\log x_1, \dots, \log x_n) + (\log y_1, \dots, \log y_n) = Tx + Ty. \end{aligned}$$

Also,

$$T(c \cdot x) = T((x_1^c, \dots, x_n^c)) = (\log(x_1^c), \dots, \log(x_n^c)) = (c \log x_1, \dots, c \log x_n) = c(Tx).$$

**Solution:** False since scalar multiplication does not satisfy the vector space axioms.

#### Problem 5

Let  $V$  be a vector space,  $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$  bijective, and  $c$  a nonzero scalar. Prove that  $cT$  is bijective and that  $(cT)^{-1} = c^{-1}T^{-1}$ .

**Proof.** Let  $v, v' \in V$  and suppose  $cT(v) = cT(v')$ . Then  $cT(v) = cT(v') \iff cT(v) - cT(v') = 0 \iff c(T(v) - T(v')) = 0$ . Since  $c \neq 0$ , we must have  $T(v) = T(v')$ . Since  $T$  is injective, it follows that  $v = v'$ . Thus  $cT$  is injective.

Let  $v \in V$ . Since  $c \neq 0$ , the scalar  $\frac{1}{c}$  exists. Since  $V$  is closed under scalar multiplication,  $\frac{1}{c} \cdot v = \frac{v}{c} \in V$ . Since  $T$  is surjective, there exists  $x \in V$  such that  $T(x) = \frac{v}{c}$ . Then  $cT(x) = c(\frac{v}{c}) = v$ . Thus  $cT$  is surjective.

Let  $v \in V$ , and suppose  $(cT)^{-1}(v) = x$ . Then  $cT(x) = v \implies T(x) = \frac{v}{c} \implies x = T^{-1}(\frac{v}{c}) = T^{-1}(c^{-1}v)$ . Thus  $(cT)^{-1} = c^{-1}T^{-1}$ .

#### Problem 6

Let  $T : V \rightarrow W$  be a bijective linear mapping. For each  $S \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ , define  $\rho : \mathcal{L}(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{L}(W)$  (note that the product is defined). Prove that  $\rho : \mathcal{L}(V) \rightarrow \mathcal{L}(W)$  is a bijective linear mapping such that  $\rho(RS) = \rho(R)\rho(S)$  for all  $R, S \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ .

**Proof.** Since the composition of linear mappings is linear,  $TST^{-1}$  is a linear mapping. Let  $R, S \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ . Then

$$\rho(RS) = T(RS)T^{-1} = (TRT^{-1})(TST^{-1}) = \rho(R)\rho(S).$$

Suppose  $\rho(S)(v) = 0$  for some  $v \in W$ . Then  $\rho(S)(v) = 0 \iff TST^{-1}(v) = 0$ . Now  $v = T(x)$  for some  $x \in V$  thus  $TST^{-1}(T(x)) = TS(x) = 0$ . Then since  $T$  is injective  $S(x) = 0$  thus  $\rho$  is injective. It is surjective because for any  $U \in \mathcal{L}(W)$ , setting  $S = T^{-1}UT$  gives  $\rho(S) = U$ .

**Problem 7**

Let  $V$  be a vector space,  $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ . Prove:

1. If  $T^2 = 0$  then  $I - T$  is bijective.
2. If  $T^n = 0$  for some positive integer  $n$ , then  $I - T$  is bijective.

**Proof.** Suppose  $T^2 = 0$ . Let  $v \in V$  and suppose  $(I - T)(v) = 0 \implies T(v) - T^2(v) = 0 \implies T(v) = 0$ . But  $I(v) - T(v) = 0 \implies TI(v) - T^2(v) = T(0) \implies v - T(v) = 0 \implies v = T(v)$ . Thus  $v = 0$ . It follows that  $I - T$  is injective.

Let  $y \in V$ . We want to find  $x \in V$  such that  $(I - T)(x) = y$ . Let  $x = y + T(y)$ . Then  $(I - T)(x) = (I - T)(y + T(y)) = I(y + T(y)) - T(y + T(y)) = I(y) + IT(y) - T(y) - T^2(y) = y + T(y) - T(y) = y$ . ■

**Proof.** We proceed via induction on  $n$ . The previous proof shows the base case  $n = 2$ . Suppose for some  $n - 1$ ,  $T^{n-1} = 0$  implies  $I - T$  is bijective. Now suppose  $T^n = 0$ . Let  $v \in V$  and suppose  $(I - T)(v) = 0$ . Composing with  $T^{n-1}$ , we get  $T^{n-1}(v) - T^n(v) = T^{n-1}(v) = 0$ . By the induction hypothesis, this implies  $v = 0$ , so  $I - T$  is injective.

For surjectivity, let  $y \in V$  and set  $x = y + T(y) + \dots + T^{n-1}(y)$ . Then  $(I - T)(x) = y$ , so  $I - T$  is bijective. ■

**Problem 8**

Let  $U, V, W$  be vector spaces over the same field. Form the product vector spaces  $U \times V, V \times W$  (Definition 1.3.11), then the product vector spaces  $(U \times V) \times W$  and  $U \times (V \times W)$ . Prove that  $(U \times V) \times W \cong U \times (V \times W)$ .

**Proof.** Consider the mapping

$$\rho : (U \times V) \times W \longrightarrow U \times (V \times W), \quad \rho((x_1, x_2), x_3) = (x_1, (x_2, x_3)).$$

Suppose  $\rho((x_1, x_2), x_3) = \rho((y_1, y_2), y_3)$ . Then  $(x_1, (x_2, x_3)) = (y_1, (y_2, y_3))$ , so  $x_1 = y_1, x_2 = y_2, x_3 = y_3$ . Thus  $((x_1, x_2), x_3) = ((y_1, y_2), y_3)$ , and  $\rho$  is injective.

Let  $(u, (v, w)) \in U \times (V \times W)$ . Then  $\rho((u, v), w) = (u, (v, w))$ . Thus  $\rho$  is surjective. ■

**Problem 9**

Prove that  $\mathbb{R}^2 \times \mathbb{R}^3 \cong \mathbb{R}^5$ .

**Proof.** Consider the mapping

$$\rho : \mathbb{R}^2 \times \mathbb{R}^3 \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}^5, \quad \rho(((x_1, x_2), (x_3, x_4, x_5))) = (x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4, x_5)$$

Suppose  $\rho(((x_1, x_2), (x_3, x_4, x_5))) = \rho(((y_1, y_2), (y_3, y_4, y_5)))$ . Then  $(x_1, x_2) = (y_1, y_2)$  and  $(x_3, x_4, x_5) = (y_3, y_4, y_5)$ . Thus  $((x_1, x_2), (x_3, x_4, x_5)) = ((y_1, y_2), (y_3, y_4, y_5))$ , and  $\rho$  is injective.

Let  $(x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4, x_5) \in \mathbb{R}^5$ . Then  $\rho(((x_1, x_2), (x_3, x_4, x_5))) = (x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4, x_5)$ . Thus  $\rho$  is surjective. ■

**Problem 10**

With notations as in Exercice 8, prove that  $V \times W \cong W \times V$ .

**Proof.** Consider the mapping

$$\rho : V \times W \longrightarrow W \times V, \quad \rho((v, w)) = (w, v).$$

Suppose  $\rho((v_1, w_1)) = \rho((v_2, w_2))$ . Then  $(w_1, v_1) = (w_2, v_2)$ , so  $v_1 = v_2$  and  $w_1 = w_2$ . Thus  $(v_1, w_1) = (v_2, w_2)$ , and  $\rho$  is injective.

Let  $(w, v) \in W \times V$ . Then  $\rho((v, w)) = (w, v)$ . Thus  $\rho$  is surjective. ■

#### Problem 11

With notations as in Example 2.4.2, prove that  $(x_1, x_2) \mapsto (x_1, x_2 + x_2, 0)$  is an isomorphism  $\mathbb{R}^2 \mapsto W$ .

**Proof.** Consider the mapping

$$\rho : \mathbb{R}^2 \longrightarrow W, \quad \rho((x_1, x_2)) = (x_1, x_2, 0).$$

Suppose  $\rho((x_1, x_2)) = \rho((y_1, y_2))$ . Then  $(x_1, x_2, 0) = (y_1, y_2, 0)$ , so  $x_1 = y_1$  and  $x_2 = y_2$ . Thus  $(x_1, x_2) = (y_1, y_2)$ , and  $\rho$  is injective.

Let  $(x_1, x_2, 0) \in W$ . Then  $\rho((x_1, x_2)) = (x_1, x_2, 0)$ . Thus  $\rho$  is surjective. ■

## 2.5 Equivalence Relations and Quotient Sets

#### Problem 2

Let  $X$  be the set of all nonzero vectors in  $\mathbb{R}^n$ , that is,  $X = \mathbb{R}^n - \{\theta\}$ . For  $x, y$  in  $X$ , write  $x \sim y$  if  $x$  is proportional to  $y$ , that is, if there exists a scalar  $c$  (necessarily nonzero) such that  $x = cy$ ; this is an equivalence relation in  $X$ .

**Proof.** Notice that  $x = 1x$ , thus  $x \sim x$ .

Suppose  $x \sim y$ . Then  $x = cy$  for some scalar  $c$ . Since  $c \neq 0$ , we have  $\frac{1}{c}x = y$ . Thus  $y \sim x$ .

Suppose  $x \sim y$  and  $y \sim z$ . Then  $x = c_1y$  and  $y = c_2z$  for some scalars  $c_1, c_2$ . Then  $x = c_1y = c_1(c_2z) = (c_1c_2)z$ . Thus  $x \sim z$ . ■

#### Problem 4

If  $\lambda$  is a nonempty set of vector spaces over the field  $F$ , then the relation of isomorphism (2.4.1) is an equivalence relation in  $\lambda$ .

**Proof.** Let  $x, y, z \in \lambda$ . Notice that  $x \sim x$  through the identity mapping.

Suppose  $x \sim y$ . Then there exists an isomorphism  $\rho$  such that  $\rho(x) = y$ . But then  $x = \rho^{-1}(y)$ , thus  $y \sim x$ .

Suppose  $x \sim y$  and  $y \sim z$ . Then there exist  $\rho_1, \rho_2$  such that  $\rho_1(x) = y$  and  $\rho_2(y) = z$ . Then  $z = \rho_2(\rho_1(x))$ . Thus  $x \sim z$ . ■

#### Problem 9

Let  $f : X \longrightarrow Y$  be any mapping,  $x \sim x'$  the equivalence relation defined by  $f(x) = f(x')$  (2.5.1),  $q : X \longrightarrow X/\sim$  the quotient mapping (2.5.17).

Define a mapping  $g : X/\sim \longrightarrow f(X)$  as follows : if  $u \in X/\sim$  define  $g(u) = f(x)$ , where  $x$  is any element of  $X$  such that  $u = q(x)$ . [If also  $u = q(x')$  then  $x \sim x'$ , so  $f(x) = f(x')$ ; thus  $g(u)$  depends only on  $u$  not on the particular  $x$  chosen to represent the class  $u$ .] Prove (cf. Fig. 10):

1.  $g$  is bijective;
2.  $f = i \circ g \circ q$ , where  $i : f(X) \longrightarrow Y$  is the insertion mapping (Appendix A.3.8).

In particular, if  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  is surjective, then  $g : X/\sim \rightarrow Y$  is bijective.

**Proof.** Suppose  $u, u' \in X/\sim$  such that  $g(u) = g(u')$ . By definition,  $g(u) = f(x)$  and  $g(u') = f(x')$  for some  $x, x' \in X$  with  $u = q(x)$  and  $u' = q(x')$ . Then  $f(x) = f(x')$ , so  $x \sim x'$ . Thus  $q(x) = q(x')$ , and therefore  $u = u'$ . Thus  $g$  is injective.

Let  $y$  be an arbitrary element of  $f(X)$ . Then  $y = f(x)$  for some  $x \in X$ . Let  $u = q(x) \in X/\sim$ . By definition of  $g$ , we have  $g(u) = f(x) = y$ . Thus  $g$  is surjective. ■

**Proof.** Let  $x \in X$ . Then  $q(x) \in X/\sim$  and  $g(q(x)) = f(x)$  by definition of  $g$ . Since  $i : f(X) \rightarrow Y$  is the insertion mapping,  $i(f(x)) = f(x)$ . Thus  $(i \circ g \circ q)(x) = f(x)$  so  $f = i \circ g \circ q$ .

Suppose  $f : X \rightarrow Y$  is surjective. Then  $f(X) = Y$ , so  $g : X/\sim \rightarrow Y$ .

Suppose  $u, u' \in X/\sim$  such that  $g(u) = g(u')$ . Then  $g(u) = f(x)$  and  $g(u') = f(x')$  for some  $x, x' \in X$ . Thus  $f(x) = f(x')$ , so  $x \sim x'$  and thus  $u = u'$ . Thus  $g$  is injective.

Let  $y \in Y$ . Since  $f$  is surjective there exists  $x \in X$  such that  $f(x) = y$ . Let  $u = q(x) \in X/\sim$ . Then  $g(u) = f(x) = y$ . Thus  $g$  is surjective. ■

#### Problem 10

For  $x, y$  in  $\mathbb{R}$ , write  $x \sim y$  if  $x - y$  is an integer (that is,  $x - y \in \mathbb{Z}$ ); this is an equivalence relation in  $\mathbb{R}$ . The quotient set is denoted  $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ ; the equivalence class  $[x]$  of  $x \in \mathbb{R}$  is the set  $x + \mathbb{Z} = \{x + n \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ .

1. There is a connection between functions defined on  $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$  and functions defined on  $\mathbb{R}$  that are periodic of period 1; can you make it precise?
2. There exists a bijection  $g : \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow U$ , where  $U = \{(a, b) \in \mathbb{R}^2 \mid a^2 + b^2 = 1\}$  is the 'unit circle' in  $\mathbb{R}^2$ . [Hint: Apply Exercise 9 to the function  $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow U$  defined by  $f(t) = (\cos 2\pi t, \sin 2\pi t)$ .]

**Solution:** Consider a periodic function of period 1, say  $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ . Then for all  $x \in \mathbb{R}$  and all  $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ ,

$$f(x + n) = f(x).$$

Thus  $f$  takes the same value on all elements of the equivalence class

$$[x] = x + \mathbb{Z}.$$

Conversely, any function defined on  $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$  determines a function on  $\mathbb{R}$  that is periodic of period 1 by composition with the quotient map.

**Proof.** Consider the function

$$f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow U, \quad f(t) = (\cos 2\pi t, \sin 2\pi t).$$

Notice that  $f(t + n) = f(t)$  for all  $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ , so  $f$  is constant on equivalence classes of  $\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z}$ . By Exercise 9 there is a map

$$g : \mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow U, \quad g([t]) = f(t).$$

Suppose  $g([t]) = g([s])$ . Then  $f(t) = f(s)$  so  $t - s \in \mathbb{Z}$ . Thus  $[t] = [s]$ . Suppose  $(a, b) \in U$ . There exists  $t \in [0, 1)$  such that  $(\cos 2\pi t, \sin 2\pi t) = (a, b)$ , so  $(a, b) = g([t])$ . ■

#### Problem 11

For  $x, y$  in  $\mathbb{R}$ , write  $x \sim y$  if  $x - y$  is an integral multiple of  $2\pi$  (that is,  $x - y \in 2\pi\mathbb{Z}$ ). With an eye on Exercise 10, discuss periodic functions of period  $2\pi$  and describe a bijection of  $\mathbb{R}/2\pi\mathbb{Z}$  onto the unit circle  $U$ .

**Solution:** The equivalence class of  $x \in \mathbb{R}$  in  $\mathbb{R}/2\pi\mathbb{Z}$  is  $[x] = \{x + 2\pi n \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ . A function  $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  is periodic of period  $2\pi$  if  $f(x + 2\pi) = f(x)$  for all  $x \in \mathbb{R}$ . A bijection of  $\mathbb{R}/2\pi\mathbb{Z}$  onto the unit circle  $U = \{(a, b) \in \mathbb{R}^2 \mid a^2 + b^2 = 1\}$  can be defined as

$$g : \mathbb{R}/2\pi\mathbb{Z} \rightarrow U, \quad g([x]) = (\cos x, \sin x),$$

## 2.6 Quotient Vector Spaces

### Problem 1

**Prove that if  $V = M \oplus N$  (1.6, Exercise 12) then  $V/M \cong N$ . [Hint: Restrict the quotient mapping  $V \rightarrow V/M$  to  $N$  (Appendix A.3.8, and calculate the kernel and range of the restricted mapping.)]**

**Proof.** Suppose  $V = M \oplus N$ . Let  $q : V \rightarrow V/M$  be the quotient mapping. Then consider  $(q \mid N) : N \rightarrow V/M$ , which is the restriction of  $q$  to  $N$ . It was shown in the proof of Theorem 2.6.1 that  $q$  is linear. Suppose  $x \in N$  such that  $(q \mid N)(x) = [0]$ . By definition, this means  $x \in M$ . But  $x \in N$  and  $V = M \oplus N$  thus  $x = 0$ . Thus  $(q \mid N)$  is injective. Let  $[y] \in V/M$ . Since  $V = M \oplus N$  then  $y = m + n$  with  $m \in M$  and  $n \in N$ . Then  $(q \mid N)(n) = [n] = [m + n] = [y]$ . Thus  $(q \mid N)$  is surjective. Therefore  $q \mid N$  is bijective, and it follows that  $V/M \cong N$ . ■

### Problem 2

**Let  $M$  and  $N$  be linear subspaces of the vector spaces  $V$  and  $W$ , respectively. Form the product vector space  $V \times W$  (Definition 1.3.11). Then  $M \times N$  is a linear subspace of  $V \times W$  and**

$$(V \times W)/(M \times N) \cong (V/M) \times (W/N).$$

**Prove this by showing that**

$$(x, y) + M \times N \rightarrow (x + M, y + N),$$

**defines a function  $(V \times W)/(M \times N) \rightarrow (V/M) \times (W/N)$  and that this function is linear and bijective. [The essential first step to show that if  $u = (x, y) + M \times N = (x', y') + M \times N$ , then  $(x + M, y + N) = (x' + M, y' + N)$ , that is, the proposed functional value at  $u$  depends only on  $u$  and not on the particular ordered pair  $(x, y) \in u$  chosen to represent it (cf. the proof of Theorem 2.6.1).]**

**Proof.** Let  $q : (V \times W)/(M \times N) \rightarrow (V/M) \times (W/N)$  be a mapping defined as

$$q((x, y) + M \times N) = (x + M, y + N).$$

**We first show that  $q$  is well defined. Suppose  $u = (x, y) + M \times N = (x', y') + M \times N$ . Then**

$$(x, y) - (x', y') \in M \times N.$$

**Thus  $(x - x', y - y') = (m, n)$  for some  $m \in M$  and  $n \in N$ . Then  $x - x' \in M$  and  $y - y' \in N$  thus  $x + M = x' + M$  and  $y + N = y' + N$ . Thus  $(x + M, y + N) = (x' + M, y' + N)$ .**

**We now show  $q$  is additive. Let  $(x, y), (x', y')$  be elements in  $V \times W$ . Then**

$$q((x, y) + (x', y')) = q((x + x', y + y')) = (x + x' + M, y + y' + N) = (x + M, y + N) + (x' + M, y' + N) = q((x, y)) + q((x', y')).$$

**We now show  $q$  is homogeneous.**

$$q(c(x, y)) = q((cx, cy)) = (cx + M, cy + N) = c(x + M, y + N) = cq(x, y).$$

**We now show  $q$  is injective. Suppose  $q((x, y)) = (0 + M, 0 + N)$ . Then  $x \in M$  and  $y \in N$ . Thus  $(x, y) \in M \times N$  so  $(x, y) + M \times N = M \times N$ . Therefore  $(x, y) = 0$  in  $(V \times W)/(M \times N)$ , and  $q$  is injective.**

**We now show  $q$  is surjective. Let  $(x + M, y + N)$  be an element in  $(V/M) \times (W/N)$ . Then  $q((x, y)) = (x + M, y + N)$ , thus  $q$  is surjective. ■**



### Problem 3

Let  $f : \mathbb{R}^3 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be the linear form  $f(x) = 2x_1 - 3x_2 + x_3$  and let  $M$  be its kernel. As in Example 2.5.9, think of  $V/M$  as the set of planes consisting of  $M$  and the planes parallel to it. If  $u$  and  $v$  are two of these planes, their sum  $u + v$  in  $V/M$  can be visualized as follows: choose a point  $P$  on the plane  $u$  and a point  $Q$  on the plane  $v$ ; add the arrows  $OP$  and  $OQ$  using the parallelogram rule, obtaining an arrow  $OR$ ; the plane through  $R$  parallel to  $M$  is  $u + v$ .

Solution: OK.

#### Problem 4

Let  $M$  be a linear subspace of  $V$ ,  $u = x + M$  and  $v = y + M$  two elements of  $V/M$ .

1. Let  $A = \{s + t \mid s \in u, t \in v\}$  be the sum of the sets  $x + M$  and  $y + M$  in the sense of Definition 1.6.9. Then  $A$  is also a coset, namely  $A = x + y + M$ . [This offers a definition of  $u + v$  that is obviously independent of the vectors  $x$  and  $y$  chosen to represent  $u$  and  $v$ .]
2. If  $c$  is a nonzero scalar, then the set  $B = \{cs \mid s \in u\}$  is a coset, namely  $B = cx + M$ . What if  $c = 0$ ?

**Proof.** Let  $a$  be an arbitrary element in  $A$  such that  $a = s + t$ . Suppose  $s = x + m$  and  $t = y + m'$  where  $m, m' \in M$ . Then taking sums we have  $s + t = x + y + m + m'$ . Now  $m + m' \in M$  since  $M$  is closed under addition. Thus  $x + y + m + m' \in x + y + M$ .

Conversely, suppose  $t \in x + y + M$  such that  $t = x + 0 + y + m$ . Then  $0, m \in M$  thus  $x + 0 \in x + M$  and  $y + m \in y + M$  thus  $t \in A$ . ■

**Proof.** Suppose  $c$  is a nonzero scalar. Let  $b$  be an arbitrary element in  $B$  such that  $b = cs$  where  $s \in u$ . Suppose  $s = x + m$  where  $m \in M$ . Then  $b = cs = c(x + m) = cx + cm$ . Now  $cm \in M$  thus  $b = cx + cm \in cx + M$ .

Conversely, suppose  $t$  is an arbitrary element in  $cx + M$  such that  $t = cx + m$  where  $m \in M$ . Since  $m \in M$  and  $c \neq 0$  we have  $\frac{1}{c} \cdot m = \frac{m}{c} \in M$ , so  $t = cx + m \iff t = c(x + \frac{m}{c})$ . Now  $x + \frac{m}{c} \in u$  so  $t \in B$  as required. ■

**Solution:** If  $c = 0$  then  $B$  is the set  $\{0\}$ .

#### Problem 5

Let  $V$  be a vector space,  $M$  and  $N$  linear subspaces of  $V$ , and  $x, y$  vectors in  $V$ . Prove:

1.  $x + M \subset y + N$  if and only if  $M \subset N$  and  $x - y \in N$ .
2.  $(x + M) \cap (y + N) \neq \emptyset$  if and only if  $x - y \in M + N$ .
3. If  $z \in (x + M) \cap (y + N)$  then  $(x + M) \cap (y + N) = z + M \cap N$ .

**Proof.** ( $\implies$ ) Suppose  $x + M \subset y + N$ . Let  $m$  be an arbitrary element in  $M$ . Since  $x + m \in x + M$  and  $x + M \subset y + N$  we have  $x + m = y + n$  for some  $n \in N$ . Now for arbitrary  $m \in M$ , we have  $x + m = y + n$  for some  $n \in N$ , so  $m = n - (x - y)$ . Since  $n \in N$  and  $x - y \in N$  we have  $m \in N$ . Thus  $M \subset N$  as required.

( $\impliedby$ ) Suppose  $M \subset N$  and  $x - y \in N$ . Let  $t \in x + M$  such that  $t = x + m$  for some  $m \in M$ . Since  $M \subset N$ ,  $x - y \in N$ , we have  $m \in N$  thus  $t = y + ((x - y) + m) \in y + N$ . Therefore  $x + M \subset y + N$ . ■

**Proof.** ( $\implies$ ) Suppose  $(x + M) \cap (y + N) \neq \emptyset$ . Let  $t \in (x + M) \cap (y + N)$  such that  $t = x + m$  and  $t = y + n$  for  $m \in M$  and  $n \in N$ . Then  $x + m = y + n \iff x - y = n - m \in N - M = M + N$ .

( $\impliedby$ ) Suppose  $x - y \in M + N$ . Then  $x - y = m + n$  for some  $m \in M$  and  $n \in N$ . Then  $x - n = y + m$ . Then  $x - n \in x + M$  and  $y + m \in y + M$  thus  $x + M \cap y + M \neq \emptyset$ . ■

**Proof.** Suppose  $z \in (x + M) \cap (y + N)$ . Then  $z = x + m$  and  $z = y + n$  for  $m \in M$  and  $n \in N$ . Let  $t$  be an arbitrary element in  $(x + M) \cap (y + N)$ . Then  $t = x + m'$  and  $t = y + n'$  for some  $m' \in M$  and  $n' \in N$ . Then

$$t - z = (x + m') - (x + m) \in M,$$

and

$$t - z = (y + n') - (y + n) \in N.$$

Thus  $t - z \in M \cap N$ . Thus  $t \in z + M \cap N$ . Conversely, let  $t \in z + M \cap N$ . Then  $t = z + m$  where  $m \in M \cap N$ . Thus  $t \in x + M$  and  $t \in y + N$  and therefore  $t \in (x + M) \cap (y + N)$ . ■

**Problem 6**

Let  $X$  be a nonempty set. Let  $R$  be a subset of the cartesian product  $X \times X$ , such that (i)  $R$  contains the 'diagonal'  $X \times X$ , that is,  $(x, x) \in R$  for all  $x \in X$ ; (ii)  $R$  is 'symmetric in the diagonal', that is, if  $(x, y) \in R$  then  $(y, x) \in R$ ; and (iii) if  $(x, y) \in R$  and  $(y, z) \in R$  then  $(x, z) \in R$ . Does this suggest a way of defining an equivalence relation  $x \sim y$  in  $X$ .

**Solution:**

$$x \sim y \iff (x, y) \in R$$

**Problem 7**

Let  $T : V \rightarrow W$  be a linear mapping,  $M$  a linear subspace of  $V$  such that  $M \subset \text{Ker}T$ , and  $Q : V \rightarrow V/M$  the quotient mapping. Prove:

1. There exists a (unique) linear mapping  $S : V/M \rightarrow W$  such that  $T = SQ$  (Fig. 11).
2.  $S$  is injective if and only if  $M = \text{Ker}T$ .

**Proof.** Consider  $S : V/M \rightarrow W$  defined

$$S(x + M) = T(x).$$

We first show  $S$  is well defined. Suppose  $x + M = y + M$ . Therefore  $x - y \in M$ . Since  $M \subset \text{Ker}T$ , we have  $T(x - y) = 0 \implies T(x) = T(y)$ . Then let  $x + M, y + M$  be arbitrary elements in  $V/M$ . Then

$$S((x + M) + (y + M)) = S(x + y + M) = T(x + y) = T(x) + T(y) = S(x + M) + S(y + M).$$

Let  $c$  be a scalar. Then

$$S(c(x + M)) = S(cx + M) = T(cx) = cT(x).$$

Thus  $S$  is a linear mapping. Now let  $v$  be an arbitrary element in  $V$ . Then  $(SQ)(v) = S(Q(v)) = S(v + M) = T(v)$ .

Suppose there exists  $S'$  such that  $S' : V/M \rightarrow W$  and  $T = S'Q$ . For all  $v \in V$  we have  $T(v) = S'(Q(v)) = S(Q(v))$ . Thus  $S, S'$  agree at all cosets and therefore  $S' = S$  and  $S$  is unique. ■

**Proof.** Suppose  $S$  is injective. We know  $M \subset \text{Ker}T$  so let  $t$  be an arbitrary element in  $\text{Ker}T$ . Then  $T(t) = (SQ)(t) = S(t + M) = 0$ . Since  $S$  is injective we have  $t + M = 0 + M$  thus  $t \in M$ . Thus  $M = \text{Ker}T$ .

Suppose  $M = \text{Ker}T$ . Let  $x + M$  be an arbitrary element in  $V/M$ . Suppose  $S(x + M) = 0$ . Then  $T(x) = 0$  thus  $x \in M$  and  $S$  is injective. ■

**Problem 8**

Let  $M$  be a linear subspace of  $V$ ,  $Q : V \rightarrow V/M$  the quotient mapping,  $T : V \rightarrow V$  a linear mapping such that  $T(M) \subset M$ . Prove that there exists a (unique) linear mapping:  $S : V/M \rightarrow V/M$  such that  $SQ = QT$  (Fig. 12). [Hint: Apply Exercise 7 to the linear mapping  $QT : V \rightarrow V/M$ .]

**Proof.** Let  $v$  be an arbitrary element in  $M$ . Since  $T(M) \subset M$ , we have  $T(v) \in M$ . Then  $QT(v) = Q(T(v)) = 0$ . Thus  $M \subset \text{Ker}(QT)$ . We can then apply Exercise 7 to find a linear mapping  $S : V/M \rightarrow V/M$  such that  $SQ = QT$ . ■

## 2.7 The First Isomorphism Theorem

### Problem 1

When there's a first, there's a second. The following result is called the Second isomorphism theorem. Let  $V$  be a vector space,  $M$  and  $N$  linear subspaces of  $V$ ,  $M \cap N$  their intersection and  $M + N$  their sum (1.6.9). Then  $M \cap N$  is a linear subspace of  $M$ ,  $N$  is a linear subspace of  $M + N$ , and

$$M/(M \cap N) \cong (M + N)/N.$$

[Hint: Let  $Q : V \rightarrow V/N$  be the quotient mapping and let  $T = Q|_M$  be the restriction of  $Q$  to  $M$  (Appendix 3.8), that is,  $T : M \rightarrow V/N$  and  $Tx = x + N$  for all  $x \in M$ . Show that  $T$  has range  $(M + N)/N$  and kernel  $M \cap N$ .]

**Proof.** Let  $Q : V \rightarrow V/N$  be the quotient mapping and let  $T = Q|_M$  be the restriction of  $Q$  to  $M$ , that is,  $T : M \rightarrow V/N$  and  $Tx = x + N$  for all  $x \in M$ .

We first show that  $\text{Ran}(T) = (M + N)/N$ . Notice

$$\text{Ran}(T) = T(M) = \{m + N : m \in M\}.$$

$\text{Ran}(T) \subset (M + N)/N$ : Let  $x \in \text{Ran}(T)$ . Then  $x = m + N$  for some  $m \in M$ . Since  $m \in M \subset M + N$ , we have  $m + N \in (M + N)/N$ . Thus  $\text{Ran}(T) \subset (M + N)/N$ .

$(M + N)/N \subset \text{Ran}(T)$ : Let  $x \in (M + N)/N$ . Then  $x = (m + n) + N$  for some  $m \in M, n \in N$ . But  $(m + n) + N = m + N = Tm$ , so  $x \in \text{Ran}(T)$ .

Thus

$$\text{Ran}(T) = (M + N)/N.$$

We now show that  $\text{Ker}(T) = M \cap N$ .

$\text{Ker}(T) \subset M \cap N$ : Suppose  $x \in \text{Ker}(T)$ . Then  $Tx = x + N = N$ , so  $x \in N$ . Since  $x \in M$ , we have  $x \in M \cap N$ .

$M \cap N \subset \text{Ker}(T)$ : Suppose  $x \in M \cap N$ . Then  $x \in N$ , so  $Tx = x + N = N$ . Thus  $x \in \text{Ker}(T)$ .

Thus  $\text{Ker}(T) = M \cap N$ .

Therefore, by the First Isomorphism Theorem,

$$M/(M \cap N) \cong \text{Ran}(T) = (M + N)/N.$$

### Problem 2

Let  $M, N$  be linear subspaces of the vector spaces  $V, W$  and let

$$T : V \times W \rightarrow (V/M) \times (W/N),$$

be the linear mapping defined by  $T(x, y) = (x + M, y + N)$ . Determine the kernel of  $T$  and deduce another proof of 2.6, Exercise 2.

### 2.6 Problem 2

Let  $M$  and  $N$  be linear subspaces of the vector spaces  $V$  and  $W$ , respectively. Form the product vector space  $V \times W$  (Definition 1.3.11). Then  $M \times N$  is a linear subspace of  $V \times W$  and

$$(V \times W)/(M \times N) \cong (V/M) \times (W/N).$$

**Prove this by showing that**

$$(x, y) + M \times N \longrightarrow (x + M, y + N),$$

**defines a function  $(V \times W)/(M \times N) \longrightarrow (V/M) \times (W/N)$  and that this function is linear and bijective. [The essential first step to show that if  $u = (x, y) + M \times N = (x', y') + M \times N$ , then  $(x + M, y + N) = (x' + M, y' + N)$ , that is, the proposed functional value at  $u$  depends only on  $u$  and not on the particular ordered pair  $(x, y) \in u$  chosen to represent it (cf. the proof of Theorem 2.6.1).]**

**Proof.** We must find  $(v, w) \in V \times W$  such that

$$T(v, w) = (0 + M, 0 + N) \in (V/M) \times (W/N).$$

This holds iff  $v + M = M$  and  $w + N = N$  so  $v \in M$  and  $w \in N$ . Thus

$$\ker(T) = M \times N.$$

**By the First Isomorphism Theorem**

$$(V \times W)/(M \times N) \cong \text{Ran}(T) = (V/M) \times (W/N).$$

■

**Problem 3**

Let  $V$  be a vector space over  $F$ ,  $f : V \rightarrow F$  a linear form on  $V$  (Definition 2.1.11),  $N$  the kernel of  $f$ . Prove that if  $f$  is not identically zero, then  $V/N \cong F$ . [Hint: If  $f(z) \neq 0$  and  $c$  is any scalar, evaluate  $f$  at the vector  $(c/f(z))z$ .]

**Proof.** Suppose  $f$  is not identically zero. Thus there exists  $v \in V$  such that  $f(v) \neq 0$ . Suppose  $f(v) = t$  where  $t \in F$  and let  $c$  be an arbitrary element in  $F$ . We first show  $f$  is surjective. Let  $c' = \frac{c}{t}$ . Then

$$f(c'v) = c'f(v) = \frac{c}{t} \cdot t = c.$$

Thus  $f$  is surjective. Now  $\ker(f) = N$  by definition. Thus, by the First Isomorphism Theorem

$$V/N \cong \text{Ran}(f) = F.$$

■

**Problem 4**

Let  $V$  be a vector space,  $V \times V$  the product vector space (1.3.11), and  $\nabla = \{(x, x) \mid x \in V\}$  (called the diagonal of  $V \times V$ ). Prove that  $\nabla$  is a linear subspace of  $V \times V$  and that  $(V \times V)/\nabla \cong V$ . [Hint: 2.2, Exercise 4.]

**Proof.** Firstly,  $(0, 0) \in \nabla$ . Let  $(x, x), (y, y) \in \nabla$  and  $c$  a scalar. Then  $(x, x) + (y, y) = (x + y, x + y) \in \nabla$ . Also,  $c(x, x) = (cx, cx) \in \nabla$ . Thus  $\nabla$  is a linear subspace of  $V \times V$ . Define  $f : V \times V \rightarrow V$  by  $f(x, y) = x - y$ . Then  $\ker(f) = \{(x, x) \mid x \in V\} = \nabla$ . By Exercise 4 of 2.2,  $f$  is surjective. Thus by the First Isomorphism Theorem

$$(V \times V)/\nabla \cong V.$$

■

### Problem 5

Let  $N$  be the set of vectors in  $\mathbb{R}^5$  whose last two coordinates are zero:

$$N = \{x_1, x_2, x_3, 0, 0\} \mid x_1, x_2, x_3 \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Prove that  $N$  is a linear subspace of  $\mathbb{R}^5$ ,  $\mathbb{R}^3 \cong N$ , and  $\mathbb{R}^5/N \cong \mathbb{R}^2$ . [Taking some liberties with the notation,  $\mathbb{R}^5/\mathbb{R}^3 = \mathbb{R}^2$ .]

**Proof.** Firstly,  $(0, 0, 0, 0, 0) \in N$ . Let  $(x_1, x_2, x_3, 0, 0), (y_1, y_2, y_3, 0, 0) \in N$  and  $c$  be a scalar. Then  $(x_1, x_2, x_3, 0, 0) + (y_1, y_2, y_3, 0, 0) = (x_1 + y_1, x_2 + y_2, x_3 + y_3, 0, 0) \in N$ . Also  $c(x_1, x_2, x_3, 0, 0) = (cx_1, cx_2, cx_3, 0, 0) \in N$ . Thus  $N$  is a linear subspace of  $\mathbb{R}^5$ .

Consider the mapping  $f : \mathbb{R}^3 \rightarrow N$  defined

$$f(x_1, x_2, x_3) = (x_1, x_2, x_3, 0, 0).$$

Let  $(x_1, x_2, x_3, 0, 0) \in N$ . Then  $f(x_1, x_2, x_3) = (x_1, x_2, x_3, 0, 0)$ , so  $f$  is surjective. Also, if  $f(x_1, x_2, x_3) = (0, 0, 0, 0, 0)$  then  $(x_1, x_2, x_3) = (0, 0, 0)$ , so  $f$  is injective. Thus  $f$  is bijective, and  $\mathbb{R}^3 \cong N$ .

Consider the linear mapping  $g : \mathbb{R}^5 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$  defined by

$$g(x_1, x_2, x_3, x_4, x_5) = (x_4, x_5).$$

Then  $\ker(g) = N$ , and  $g$  is surjective. Thus by the First Isomorphism Theorem

$$\mathbb{R}^5/N \cong \mathbb{R}^2.$$

### Problem 6

Let  $T$  be a set,  $A$  a subset of  $T$ ,  $V = \mathcal{F}(T, \mathbb{R})$  and  $W = \mathcal{F}(A, \mathbb{R})$  the vector spaces of functions constructed in 1.3.4. Let  $N$  be the set of all functions  $x \in V$  such that  $x(t) = 0$  for all  $t \in A$ . Then  $N$  is a linear subspace of  $V$  and  $V/N \cong W$ . [Hint: Consider the mapping  $x \mapsto x|_A$ , ( $x \in V$ ), where  $x|_A$  is the restriction of the function  $x$  to  $A$  (Appendix A.3.8).]

**Proof.** Firstly, the zero function  $0 \in V$  satisfies  $0(t) = 0$  for all  $t \in A$ , so  $0 \in N$ . Let  $x, y \in N$  and  $c$  be a scalar. Then for all  $t \in A$

$$(x + y)(t) = x(t) + y(t) = 0 + 0 = 0,$$

and

$$(cx)(t) = cx(t) = c \cdot 0 = 0.$$

Thus  $x + y \in N$  and  $cx \in N$ , so  $N$  is a linear subspace of  $V$ . Consider the mapping  $f : V \rightarrow W$  defined by

$$f(x) = x|_A.$$

Then  $f$  is linear. Also

$$\ker(f) = \{x \in V \mid x(t) = 0 \text{ for all } t \in A\} = N.$$

Since every function in  $W$  is the restriction of some function in  $V$ ,  $f$  is surjective. Thus by the First Isomorphism Theorem

$$V/N \cong W.$$

## 3 Structure of Vector Spaces

### 3.1 Linear Subspace Generated by a Subset

**Problem 1**

If  $T : V \rightarrow W$  is linear and  $A$  is a subset of  $V$  such that  $T(A)$  is generating for  $W$ , then  $T$  is surjective.

**Proof.** Let  $w$  be an arbitrary element in  $W$ . Since  $T(A)$  generates  $W$ ,  $w$  is a linear combination of elements in  $T(A)$ . Suppose

$$w = c_1 a_1 + \cdots + c_n a_n \text{ such that } a_1, \dots, a_n \in T(A).$$

But  $a_i = T(v_i)$  for some  $v_i \in V$ , so

$$c_1 a_1 + \cdots + c_n a_n = c_1 T(v_1) + \cdots + c_n T(v_n) = T(c_1 v_1) + \cdots + T(c_n v_n) = T(c_1 v_1 + \cdots + c_n v_n).$$

The last two equalities hold since  $T$  is linear. Thus  $T$  is surjective. ■

**Problem 2**

If  $M$  and  $N$  are linear subspaces of  $V$  such that  $V = M + N$  (1.6.9) and  $T : V \rightarrow V/N$  is the quotient mapping, then  $T(M) = V/N$  but  $M$  need not equal  $V$ ; thus we cannot conclude in Exercise 1 that  $A$  is a generating for  $V$ . Can you exhibit an example of such  $V, M$  and  $N$ ?

**Proof.** Consider  $V = \mathbb{R}$ ,  $M = \{0\}$ , and  $N = \mathbb{R}$ . Then  $V = M + N$ , but  $M \neq V$ . Let  $T : V \rightarrow V/N$  be the quotient map. Since  $V/N = \{0\}$ , we have  $T(M) = \{0\} = V/N$ . ■

**Problem 3**

(Substitution Principle) Suppose  $x, x_1, \dots, x_n$  are vectors such that  $x$  is a linear combination of  $x_1, \dots, x_n$  but not of  $x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}$ . Prove:

$$[\{x_1, \dots, x_n\}] = [\{x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}, x\}].$$

**Proof.** Since  $x$  is a linear combination of  $x_1, \dots, x_n$  suppose

$$x = c_1 x_1 + \cdots + c_n x_n.$$

Since  $x$  is not a linear combination of  $x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}$ , we have  $c_n \neq 0$ , so

$$x_n = \frac{1}{c_n} (x - c_1 x_1 - \cdots - c_{n-1} x_{n-1}).$$

Let  $v \in [\{x_1, \dots, x_n\}]$  and suppose

$$v = d_1 x_1 + \cdots + d_n x_n.$$

Substituting for  $x_n$ , we get

$$v = d_1 x_1 + \cdots + d_{n-1} x_{n-1} + d_n \frac{1}{c_n} (x - c_1 x_1 - \cdots - c_{n-1} x_{n-1}) \in [\{x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}, x\}].$$

Conversely, let  $v \in [\{x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}, x\}]$  and suppose

$$v = d_1 x_1 + \cdots + d_{n-1} x_{n-1} + dx.$$

Then

$$x = c_1 x_1 + \cdots + c_n x_n \implies dx = (dc_1)x_1 + \cdots + (dc_n)x_n.$$

Thus

$$v = d_1 x_1 + \cdots + d_{n-1} x_{n-1} + (dc_1)x_1 + \cdots + (dc_n)x_n \in [\{x_1, \dots, x_n\}].$$

■



**Problem 4**

Let  $S : V \rightarrow W$  and  $T : V \rightarrow W$  be linear mappings, and let  $A$  be a subset of  $V$  such that  $V = [A]$ . Prove that if  $Sx = Tx$  for all  $x \in A$ , then  $S = T$ . (Informally, a linear mapping is determined by its values on a generating set.)

**Proof.** Suppose  $Sx = Tx$  for all  $x \in A$ . Let  $x' \in V$  and since  $V = [A]$  so

$$x' = c_1 a_1 + \cdots + c_n a_n.$$

Then

$$\begin{aligned} T(x') &= T(c_1 a_1 + \cdots + c_n a_n) \\ &= T(c_1 a_1) + \cdots + T(c_n a_n) \\ &= c_1 T(a_1) + \cdots + c_n T(a_n) \\ &= c_1 S(a_1) + \cdots + c_n S(a_n) \\ &= S(c_1 a_1) + \cdots + S(c_n a_n) \\ &= S(c_1 a_1 + \cdots + c_n a_n) \\ &= S(x'). \end{aligned}$$

Thus  $Sx' = Tx'$  for all  $x' \in V$ , so  $S = T$ . ■

**Problem 5**

Let  $V$  be a vector space,  $A$  a nonempty subset of  $V$ . For each finite subset  $\{x_1, \dots, x_n\}$  of  $A$ , let

$$M(x_1, \dots, x_n) = \{a_1 x_1 + \cdots + a_n x_n \mid a_1, \dots, a_n \text{ scalars}\};$$

as noted in the proof of Corollary 3.1.5, this is a linear subspace of  $V$ . Let  $\mathcal{N}$  be the set of all linear subspaces of  $V$  obtained in this way (by considering all possible finite subsets of  $A$ ); by definition,  $[A] = \bigcup \mathcal{N}$  (the union of the subspaces belonging to  $\mathcal{N}$ ). Prove that  $[A]$  is a linear subspace of  $V$  by verifying criterion 1.6, Exercise 9.

**Problem 6**

Let  $V$  and  $W$  be vector spaces,  $V \times W$  the product vector space (1.3.11); let  $A \subset V$  and  $B \subset W$ . Prove:

1.  $[A \times B] \subset [A] \times [B]$ .
2. In general,  $[A \times B] \neq [A] \times [B]$ , **Hint:** Consider  $A = \emptyset, B = W$ ; or  $V = W = R$  and  $A = B = \{1\}$ .
3.  $[(A \times \{\emptyset\}) \cup (\{\emptyset\} \times B)] = [A] \times [B]$ . **Hint**

$$\left( \sum_{i=1}^m c_i x_i, \sum_{i=1}^m c_i(x_i, 0) + \sum_{j=1}^n d_j(0, y_j) \right).$$